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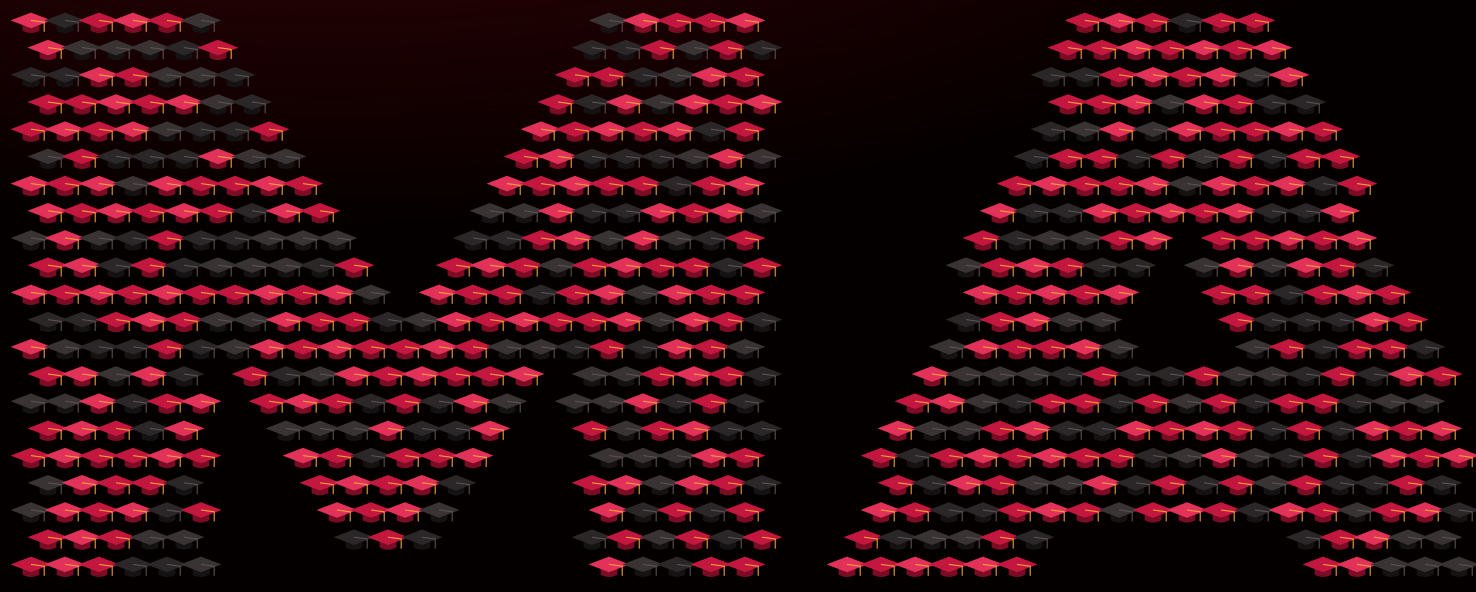
NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Massachusetts Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston

Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **61 in every 100**, mark the international share of Massachusetts's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 Massachusetts Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Massachusetts: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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The 2026 Massachusetts Talent Profile

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Massachusetts Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Massachusetts's numbers say

1. **International students earn 61% of Massachusetts's STEM master's degrees,** 8.6 points above the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 10th of 51 on dependence. The share is 43% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 12% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Massachusetts awarded 9.1K STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 7.8% of the U.S. total and 4th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed 3.5×, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in math & statistics,** where international students earned 73% of master's degrees (950 degrees; U.S. 55%). 3 STEM fields with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Massachusetts ranks 2nd of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Massachusetts 61%, Michigan 50%, Utah 7.2%, Indiana 63%, Minnesota 51%.
5. **60% of Massachusetts's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 7.7% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (21.9K) than residents left (20.7K), a net gain of 1.2K; the top destination for those leaving was New York.

61%

of the STEM master's degrees Massachusetts awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

482K #13
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −5.6% since 2015

9.1K #4
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · 3.51× since 2015

61% #10
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +20.0 pp since 2015

29% #2
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +7.8 pp since 2015

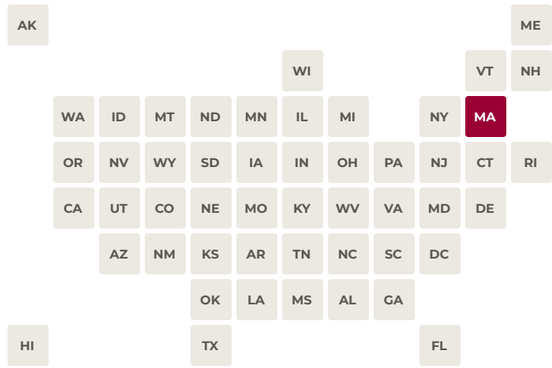
31% #5
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +9.7 pp since 2015

74% #2
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +2.7 pp since 2015

$17K #6
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +64% since 2015

60% #40
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −0.5 pp since 2016

$135K #2
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −3.5% since 2016



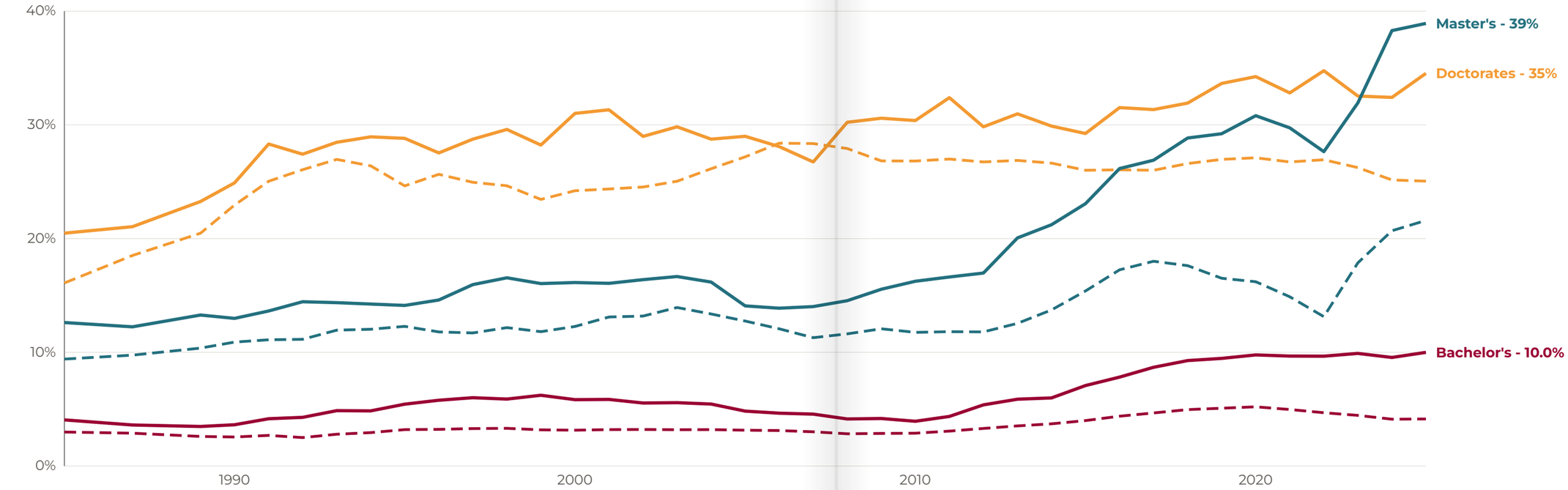
Badges give Massachusetts's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Massachusetts ranks 2nd of 51 on the international share of graduate enrollment, at 29% in 2024 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of Massachusetts's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 29% of Massachusetts's graduate enrollment and 7.9% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 10.0% of bachelor's, 39% of master's and 35% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 12% of STEM bachelor's, 61% of STEM master's and 43% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 7.8% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 4th of 51.

29%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **2nd** of 51 · +7.8 pp since 2015

39%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

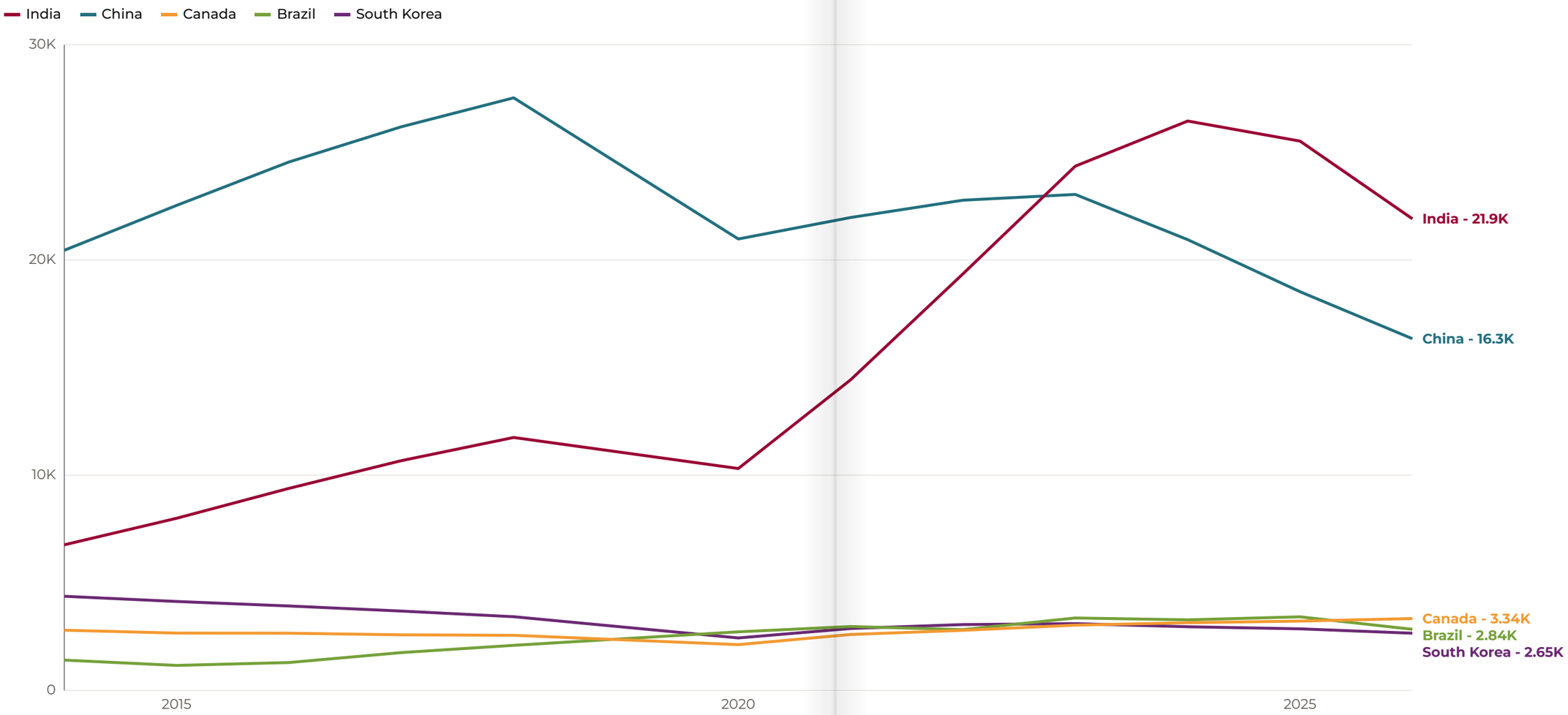
U.S. **22%** · **2nd** of 51 · +15.9 pp since 2015

61%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **10th** of 51 · +20.0 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do Massachusetts's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, Massachusetts had 76.7K active international students in SEVIS, 4th of 51. India accounted for 29% of them and China for 21%, against 27% and 18% nationally.

Students came from 187 countries, but the two largest supplied 50%. The state's total is up 9% since 2015, when it stood at 70.2K.

76.7K
Active international students, October 2026
4th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

29%
From India
U.S. **27%**

58%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

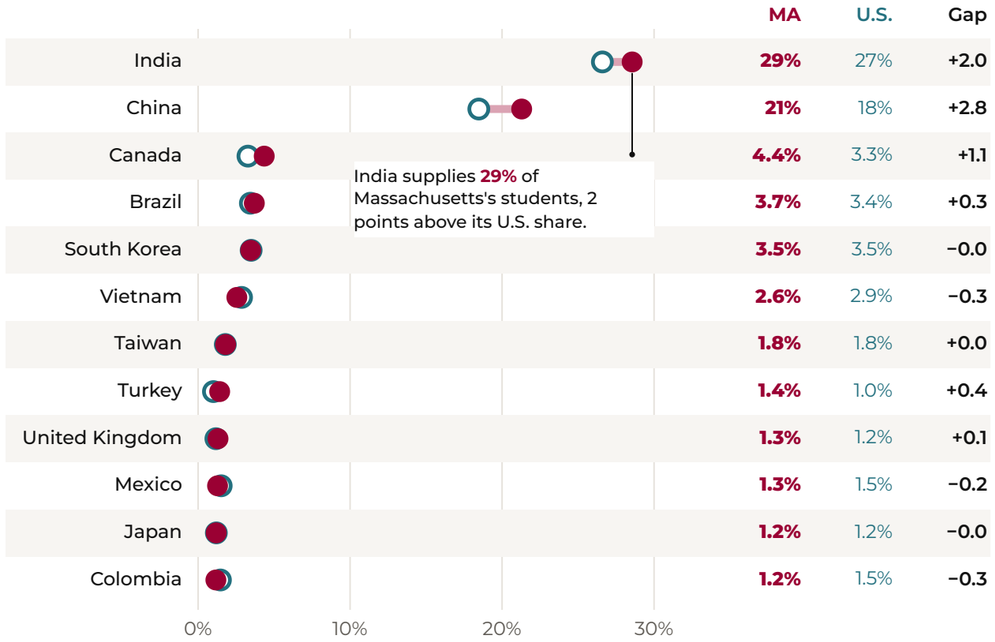
How Does Massachusetts's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, Massachusetts had **76.7K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 4th among the 50 states and DC and **6.4%** of the U.S. total. They came from 187 countries.

India supplied **29%** of them, against 27% nationally, and China **21%**, against 18%. Canada (4.4%), Brazil (3.7%), and South Korea (3.5%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **50%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 14th among the states, against 44% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is Massachusetts's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

76.7K
Active international students, October 2026
4th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

29%
From India
U.S. **27%**

21%
From China
U.S. **18%**

187
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 8.9% from 2025 and up 9.4% since 2015, when it stood at 70.2K. Its share of all U.S. international students is up 0.6 points since 2015, to **6.4%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from India went from 8K to 21.9K, China's from 22.5K to 16.3K, and Canada's from 2.66K to 3.34K.

Over the same years, the number from Brazil went from 1.16K to 2.84K and South Korea's from 4.13K to 2.65K. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in Massachusetts, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	70.2K	84.2K	**76.7K**	+9.4%	1.19M	4th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	5.9%	6.7%	**6.4%**	+0.6 pp	–	4th
Countries of citizenship represented	193	187	**187**	−3.1%	219	5th
Share from the two largest countries of origin	44%	52%	**50%**	+6.3 pp	45%	14th
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
India	8K	25.5K	**21.9K**	+174%	27%	29%
China	22.5K	18.5K	**16.3K**	−27%	18%	21%
Canada	2.66K	3.22K	**3.34K**	+25%	3.3%	4.4%
Brazil	1.16K	3.42K	**2.84K**	+144%	3.4%	3.7%
South Korea	4.13K	2.86K	**2.65K**	−36%	3.5%	3.5%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply Massachusetts's International STEM Students?

44.3K of Massachusetts's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **58%** of the total against 63% nationally, up 109% since 2015.

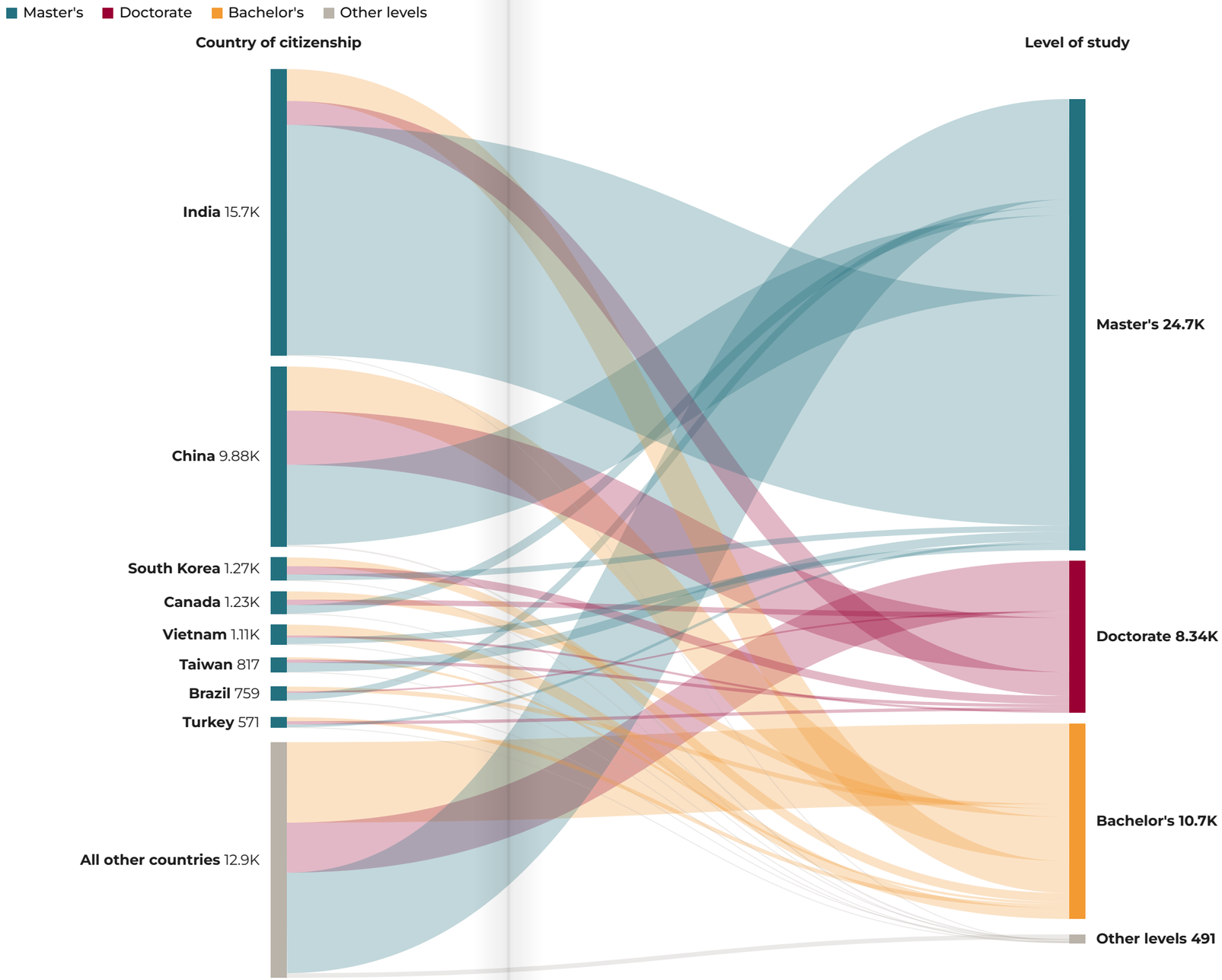
Master's students were the largest group, **24.7K**. India supplied 51% of them and China 18%.

STEM doctoral students went from 5.5K in 2015 to **8.34K**, and STEM master's students from 9.19K to 24.7K.

44.3K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **5th** of 51 · 2.09× since 2015

58%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

24.7K
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **6th** of 51 · 2.69× since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

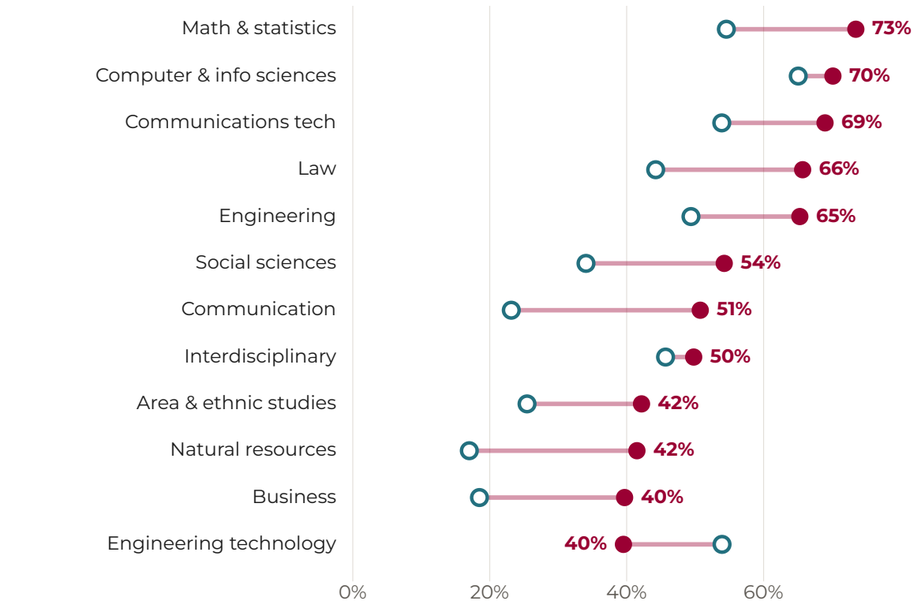
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are Massachusetts's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Massachusetts in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in math & statistics (73%, against 55% for the U.S.), computer & info sciences (70%, against 65% for the U.S.), and communications tech (69%, against 54% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

39%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **2nd** of 51

61%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **10th** of 51

70%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **18th** of 47

63%
Int. share of engineering & eng. technology master's, 2025
U.S. **50%** · **3rd** of 50

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Massachusetts first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 73% of the master's degrees in math & statistics, against 55% for the U.S.

Fields with an international majority. International students earned more than half of the master's degrees in 3 STEM fields.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	18% / 8.6%	**70% / 65%**	61% / 56%
Engineering	7.5% / 7.2%	**65% / 49%**	48% / 55%
Engineering technology	28% / 4.5%	**40% / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	21% / 17%	**73% / 55%**	59% / 53%
Physical sciences	11% / 6.0%	**37% / 33%**	43% / 38%
Biological sciences	6.2% / 3.4%	**35% / 23%**	23% / 23%
Natural resources	3.4% / 2.0%	**42% / 17%**	34% / 27%
Architecture	9.8% / 7.3%	**30% / 29%**	29% / 55%

International share in Massachusetts / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

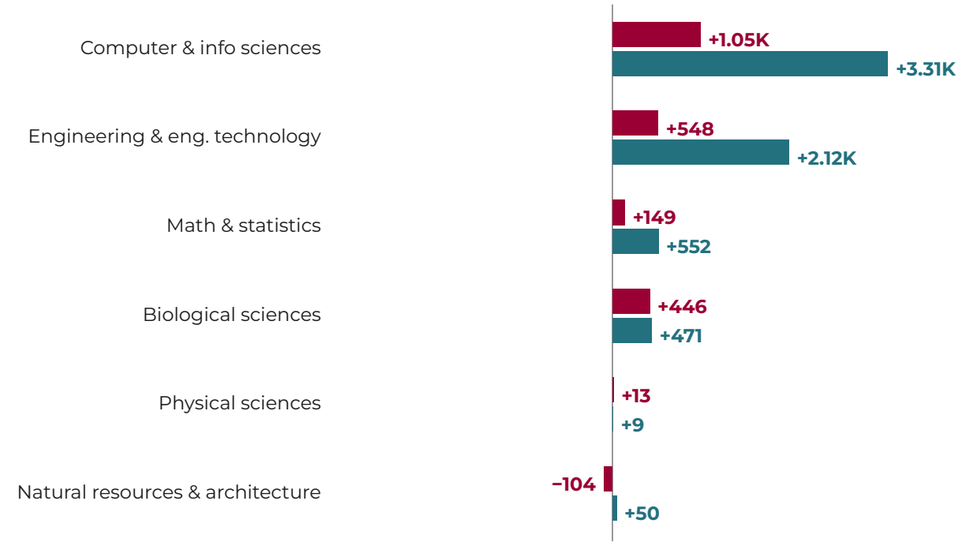
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has Massachusetts's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Massachusetts between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 15K in 2025 and 6.38K in 2015, a change of +6.51K for international students and +2.11K for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

9.1K
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **4th** of 51

30%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **5th** of 51

7.8%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
4th of 51

6.9
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **15th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Massachusetts in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 30% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 5th among the states, up 1.7 points from 29% in 2024 and up 12.6 points since 2015, when it was 18%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	1.43K	**5.79K**	+305%	4.06K	53%	70%
Engineering & eng. technology	2.52K	**5.19K**	+106%	3.29K	46%	63%
Math & statistics	249	**950**	+282%	698	59%	73%
Biological sciences	976	**1.89K**	+94%	655	19%	35%
Physical sciences	262	**284**	+8.4%	106	37%	37%
Natural resources & architecture	933	**879**	−5.8%	289	26%	33%

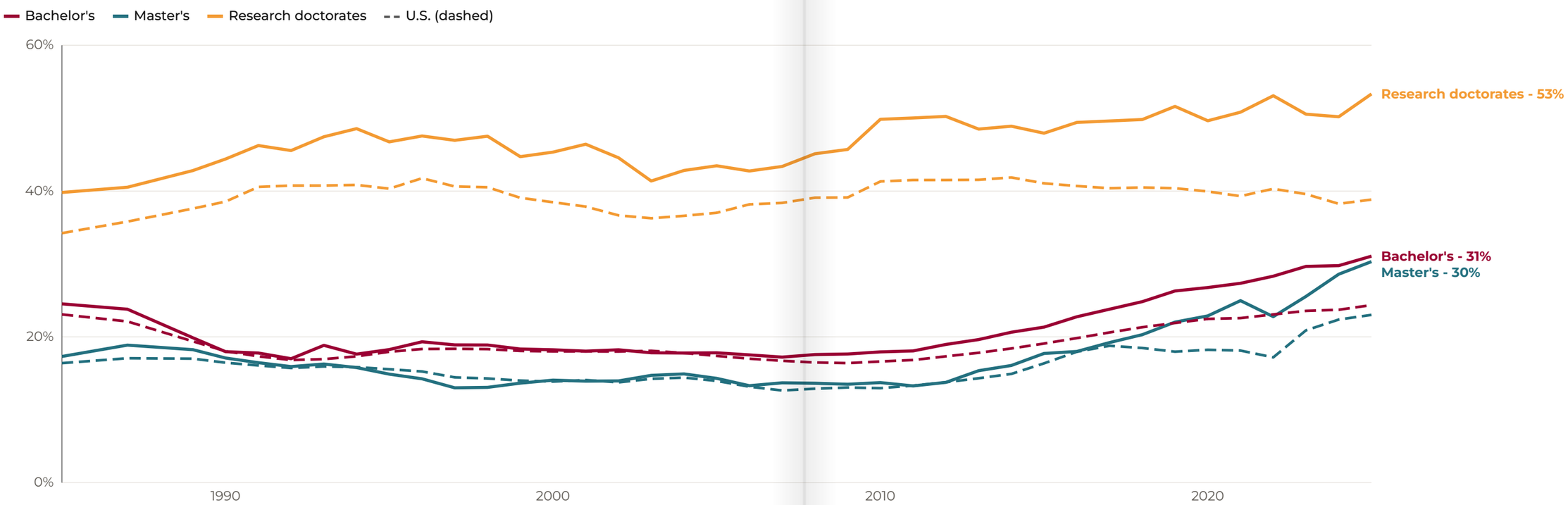
STEM master's degrees awarded in Massachusetts, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Massachusetts ranks 5th of 51 on the STEM share of bachelor's, at 31% in 2025 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 7 How Much of Massachusetts's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 31% of Massachusetts's bachelor's degrees, 30% of its master's and 53% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 12.6 points since 2015, and the state ranks 5th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 5th of 51.

31%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **5th** of 51 · +9.7 pp since 2015

30%

STEM share of master's, 2025

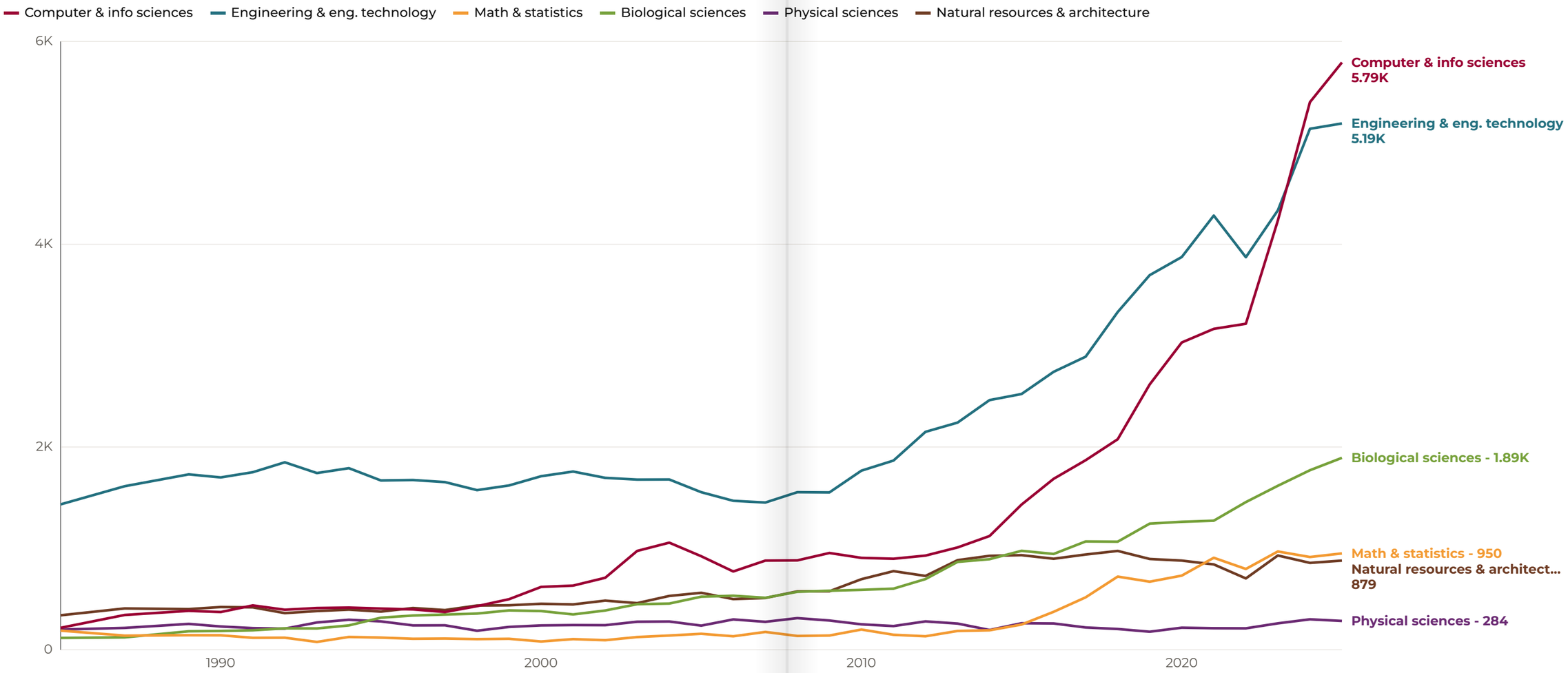
U.S. **23%** · **5th** of 51 · +12.6 pp since 2015

53%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **7th** of 51 · +5.4 pp since 2015

Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Massachusetts's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 5.79K, followed by engineering & eng. technology (5.19K) and biological sciences (1.89K). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 305% since 2015.

International students earned 9.1K of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 7.8% of the national total (4th of 51).

9.1K

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **4th** of 51 · 3.51× since 2015

7.8%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

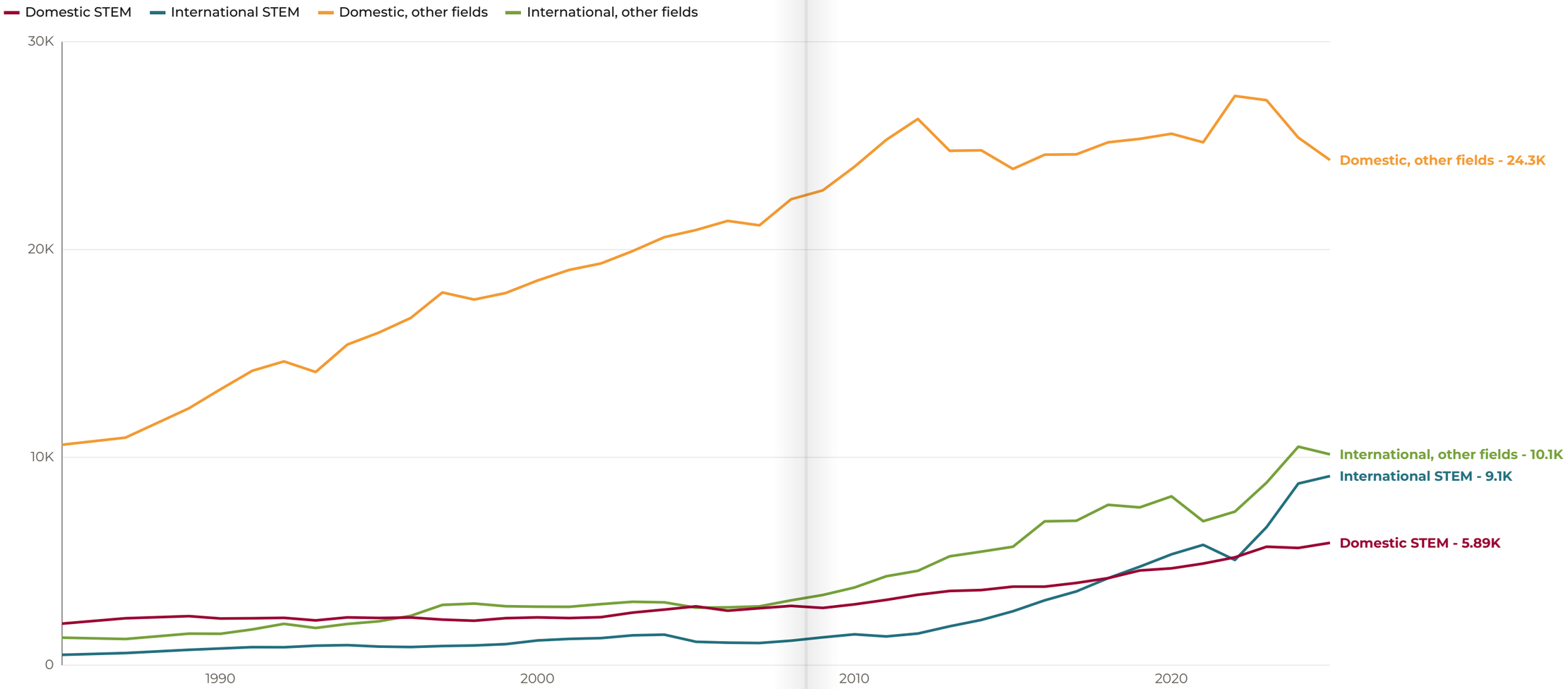
· **4th** of 51 · +3.0 pp since 2015

70%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **18th** of 47 · +17.3 pp since 2015

Figure 9 Who Earns Massachusetts's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 6.51K more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 2.11K more to domestic students.

International students earn 61% of Massachusetts's STEM master's but 29% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

39%

Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **2nd** of 51 · +15.9 pp since 2015

61%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **10th** of 51 · +20.0 pp since 2015

6.9

STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **15th** of 51 · +3.1 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Massachusetts ranks 2nd of 51 on the share of first-time students whose home is outside the US, at 7.7% in 2024 against 3.1% for the U.S.

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

41K residents stayed in Massachusetts for college in fall 2024; 21.9K students arrived from other states and 5.26K from abroad, while 20.7K residents left.

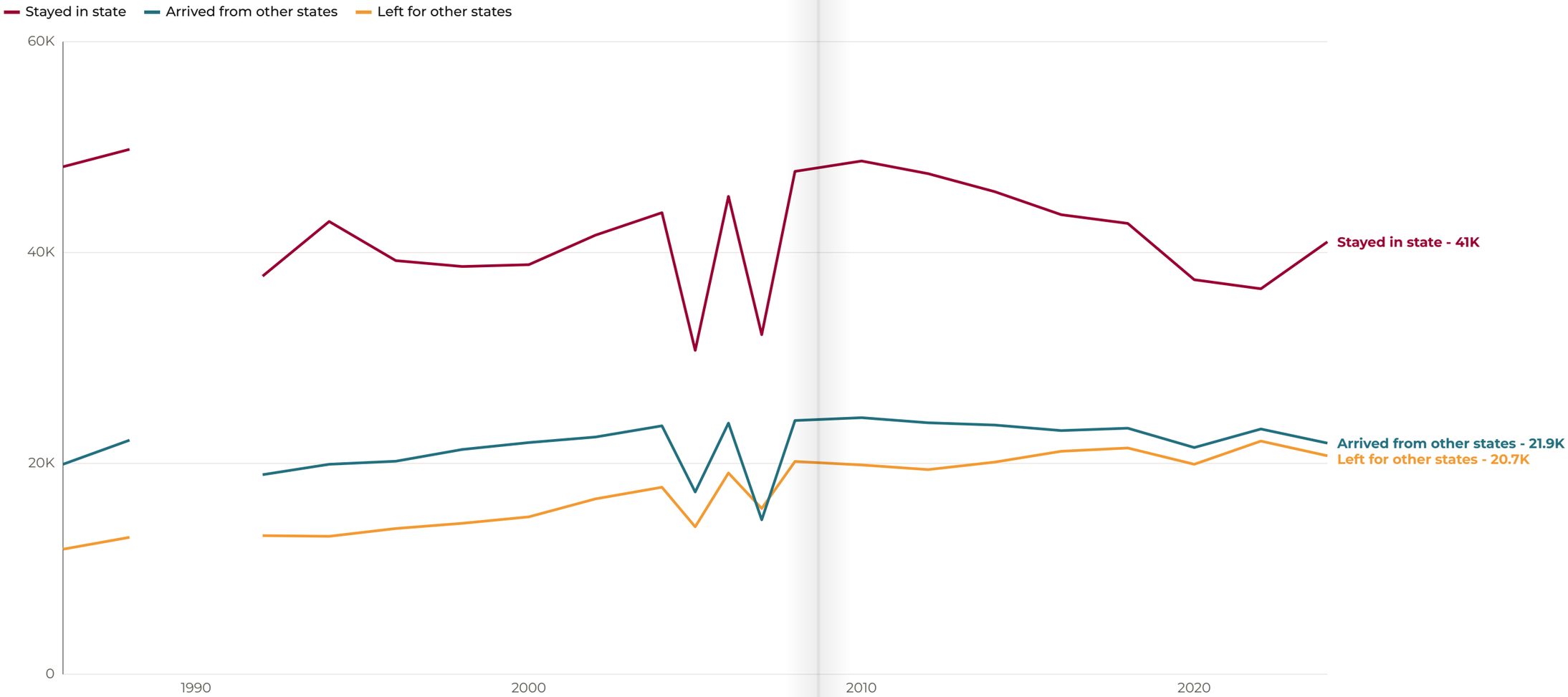
Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 60% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).

60%
First-time students from in state, 2024
· **40th** of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2016

7.7%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **2nd** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2016

+2
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
· **30th** of 51 · −1.1 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 6%, arrivals from other states are down 5%, and residents leaving are roughly flat.

Net migration was +2 per 100 resident first-time students (30th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was New York (2.7K).

Figure 12

Where Do Massachusetts's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Massachusetts's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

27.2K

First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024

Abroad **5.26K**

7.7%

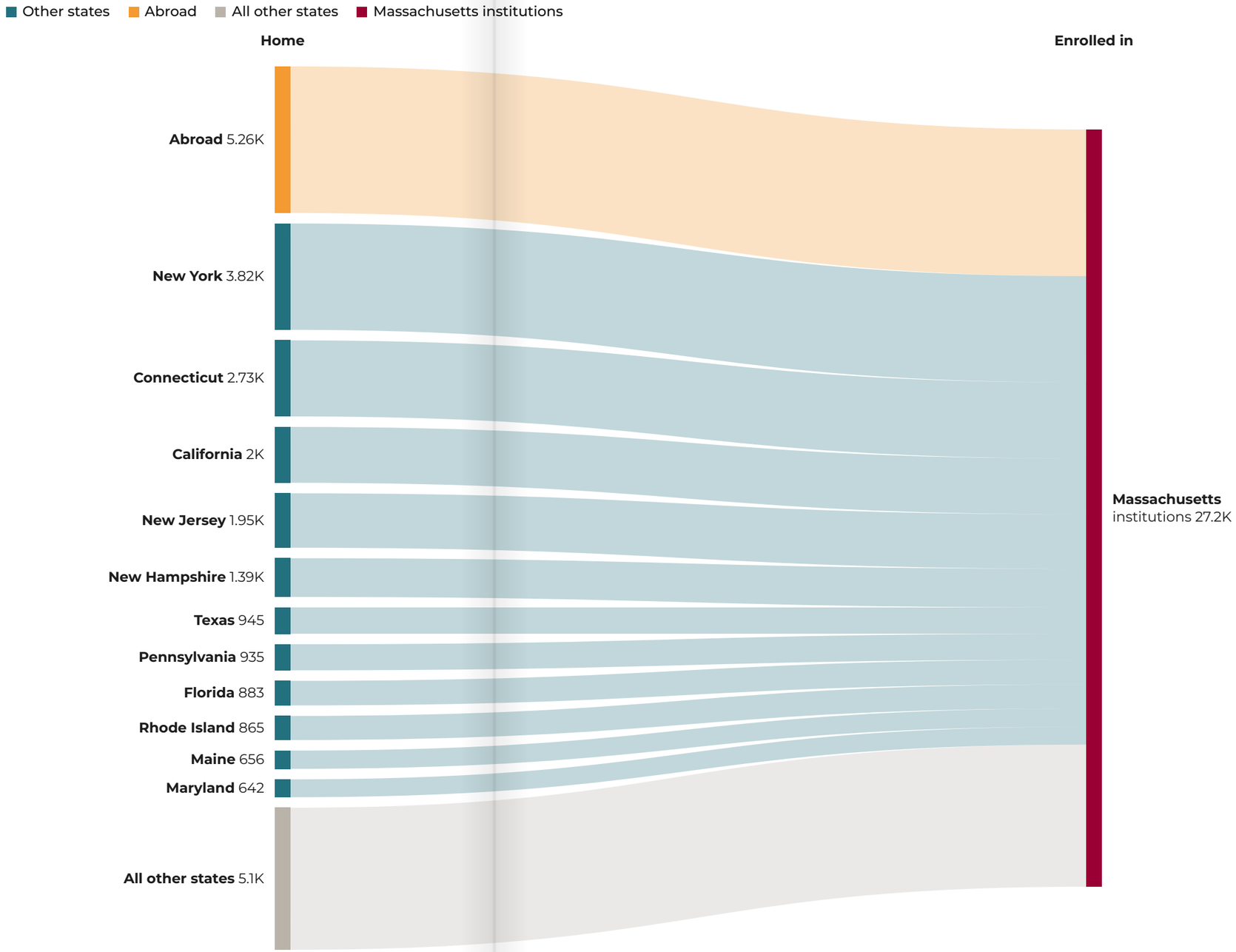
First-time students from abroad, 2024

U.S. **3.1%** · **2nd** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2016

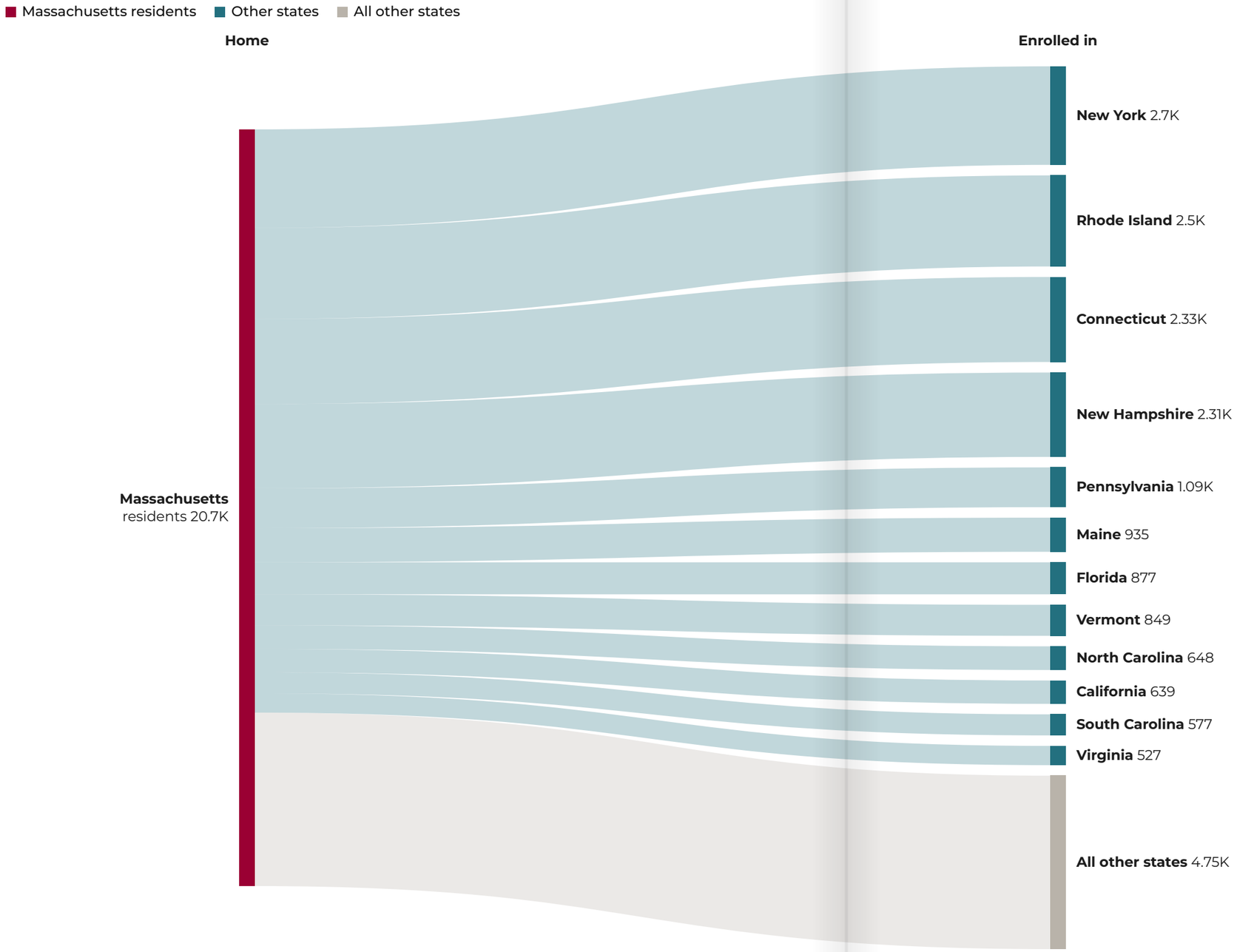
60%

First-time students from in state, 2024

40th of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do Massachusetts's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where Massachusetts residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 20.7K in fall 2024, down 6.3% from 22.1K in fall 2022 and down 2.0% since fall 2016, when it was 21.1K.

20.7K
Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024
Arrived from other states **21.9K** · **27.2K** with abroad

+2
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
30th of 51 · −1.1 since 2016

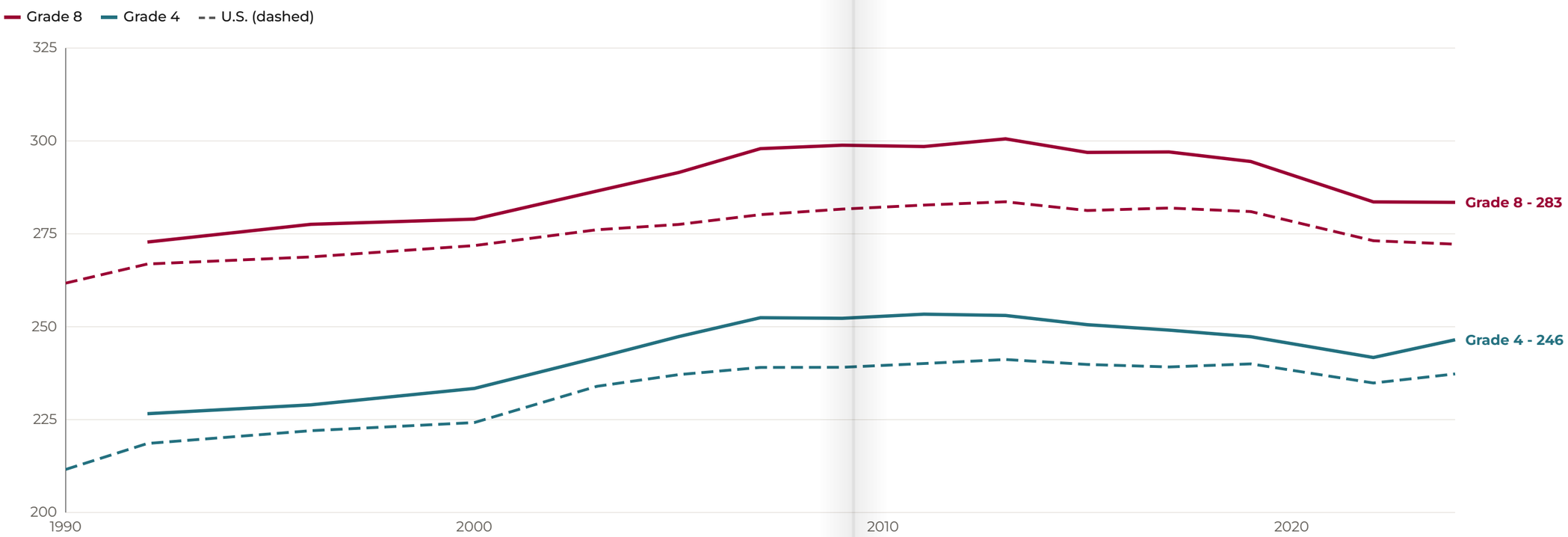
2.7K
Went to New York
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Massachusetts ranks 1st of 51 on the average grade 8 mathematics score, at 283 in 2024 against 272 for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Massachusetts's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. Massachusetts's eighth graders averaged 283 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 1st of 51 among the states.

37% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

283

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **1st** of 51 · −13.4 since 2015

37%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **1st** of 51 · −13.6 pp since 2015

268

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

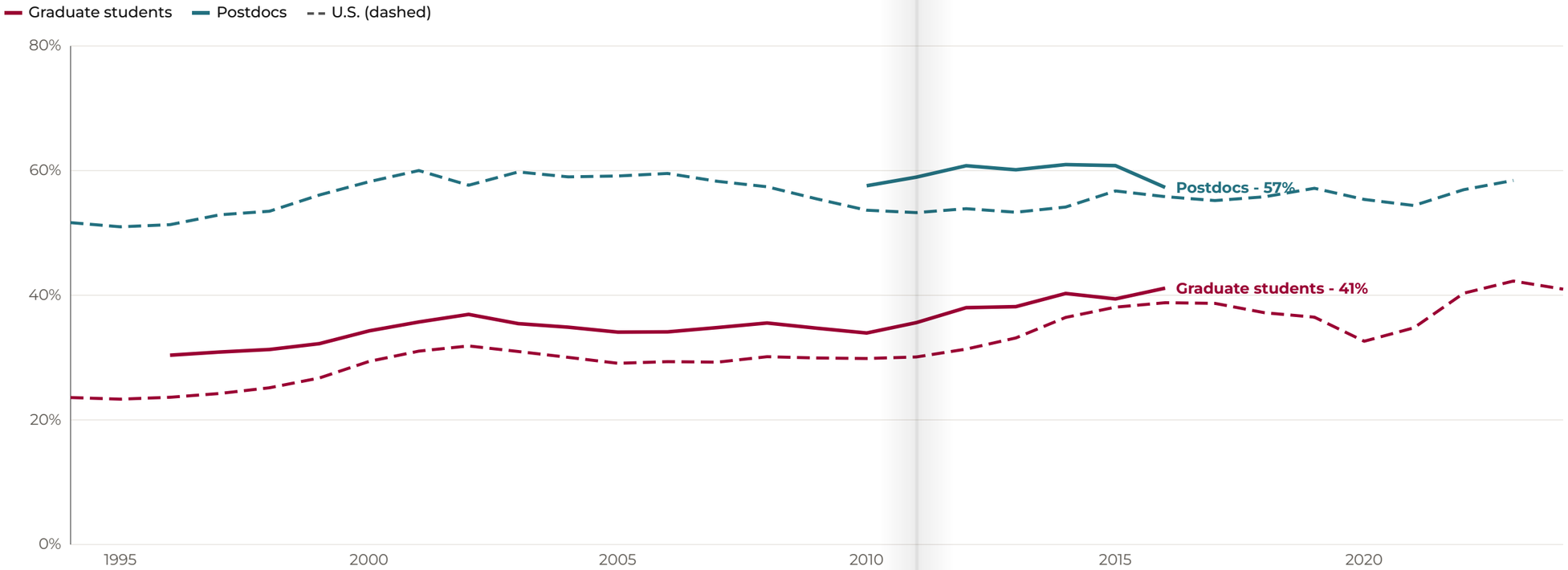
U.S. **257** · **1st** of 51 · −6.5 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Massachusetts ranks 4th of 51 on research doctorates awarded, at 3.26K in 2025 against 59K for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of Massachusetts's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 41% of Massachusetts's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 13th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 57% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 3.26K research doctorates in 2025, 5.5% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

41%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **13th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

57%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **20th** of 51 · −3.5 pp since 2015

3.26K

Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

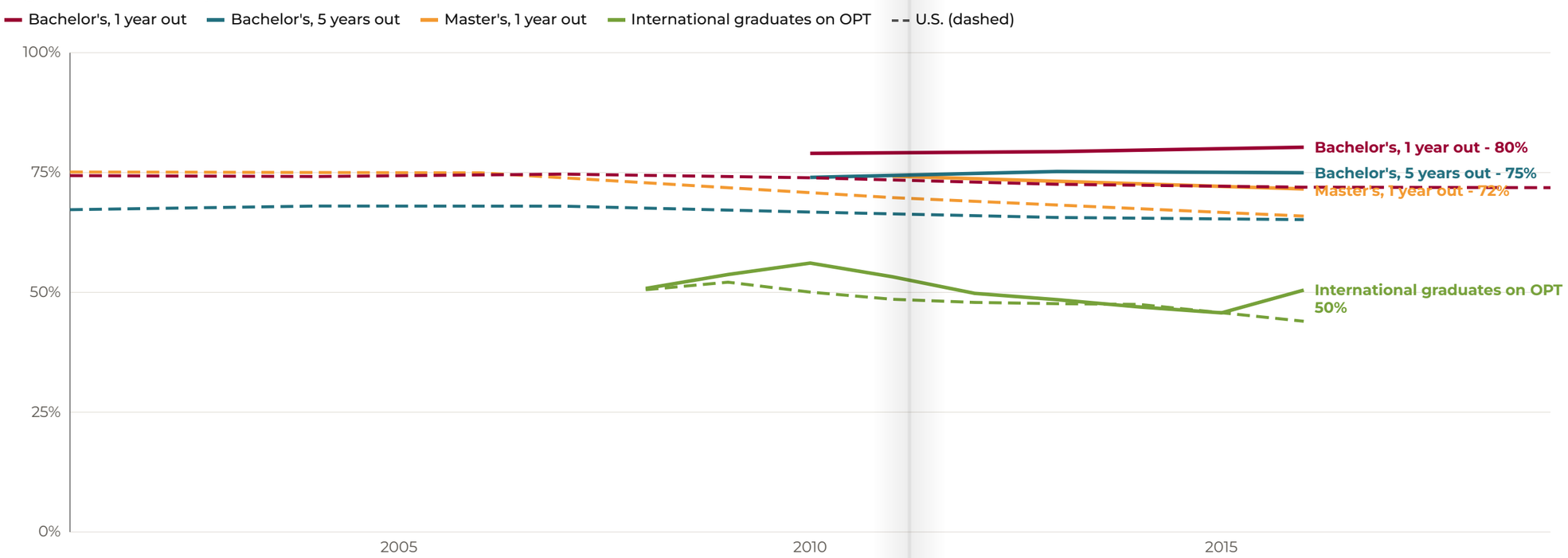
U.S. **59K** · **4th** of 51 · +15% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Massachusetts ranks 3rd of 37 on the share of bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating, at 80% in 2016 against 72% for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many of Massachusetts's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Of Massachusetts's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 80% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 75%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 50% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state lost 4.8 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

80%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2016

U.S. **72%** · **3rd** of 37 · 0.0 pp since 2016

50%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **9th** of 51 · +4.7 pp since 2015

−4.8

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

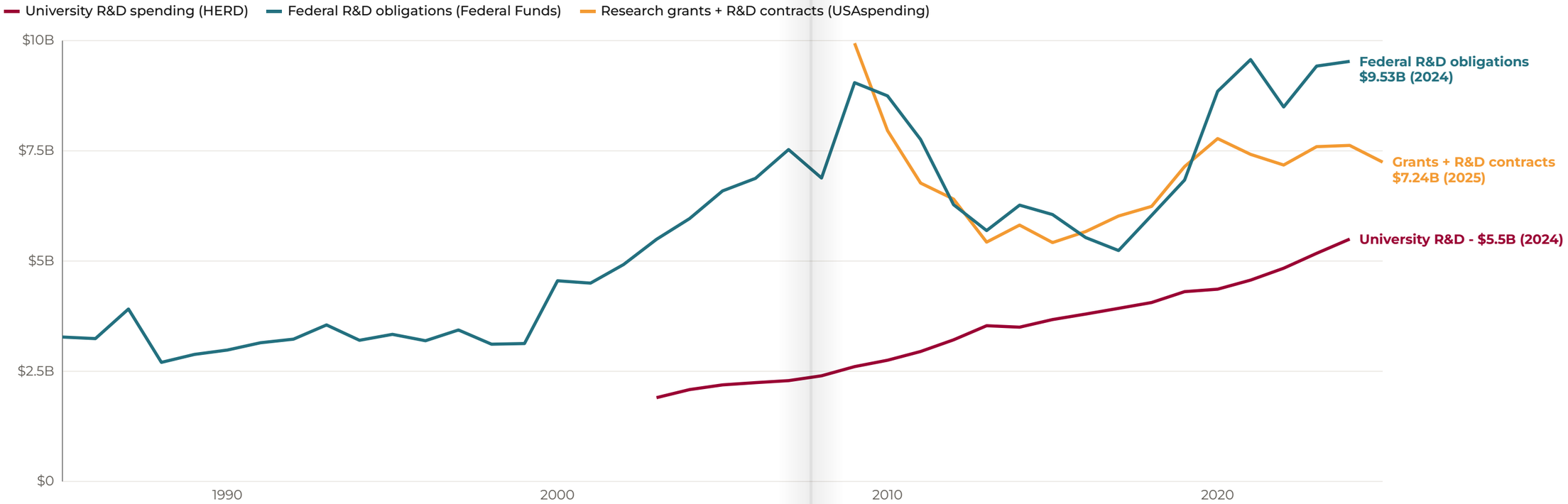
· **40th** of 51 · +4.0 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Massachusetts ranks 6th of 51 on university R&D spending, at $5.5B in 2024 against $118B for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Massachusetts?



Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

Massachusetts's universities spent $5.5B on research and development in FY2024, 6th of 51 among the states; 54% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $9.53B for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$5.5B
University R&D spending, 2024
U.S. **$118B** · **6th** of 51 · +50% since 2015

54%
Federal share of university R&D, 2024
U.S. **55%** · **22nd** of 51 · −4.2 pp since 2015

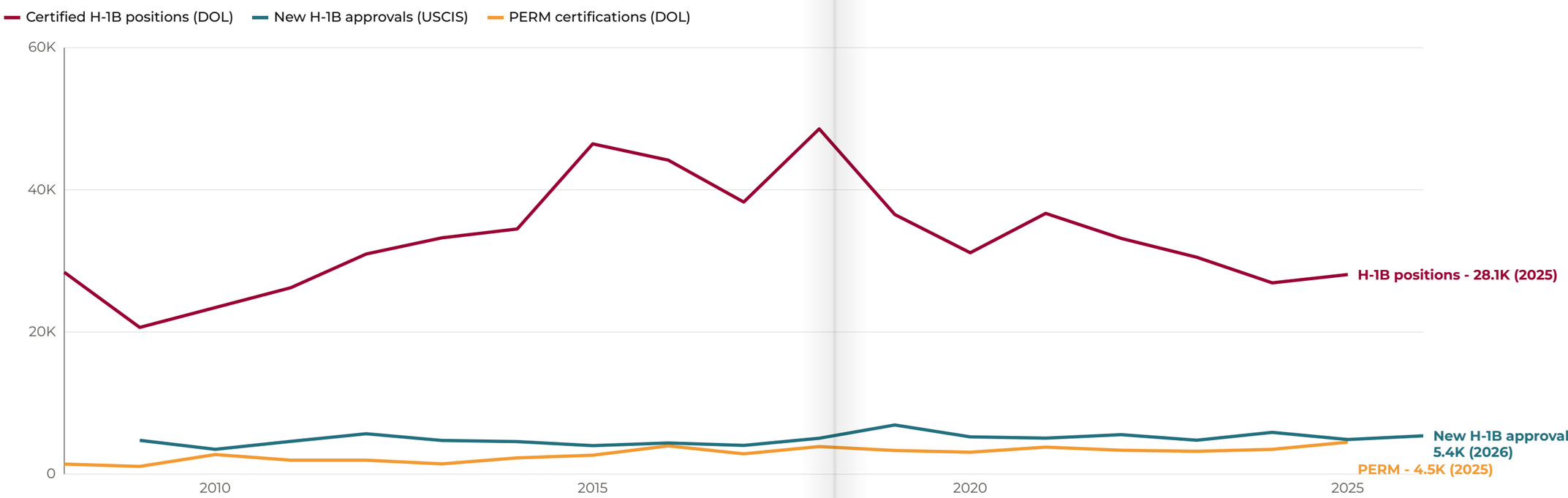
$9.53B
Federal R&D obligations, 2024
U.S. **$193B** · **6th** of 51 · +57% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Massachusetts ranks 8th of 51 on certified H-1B positions, by worksite, at 28.1K in 2025 against 914K for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Massachusetts Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 28.1K H-1B positions at Massachusetts worksites in FY2025, 8th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 5.4K new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 11.7K continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 4.5K PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 6.1% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

28.1K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **8th** of 51 · −40% since 2015

4.5K

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

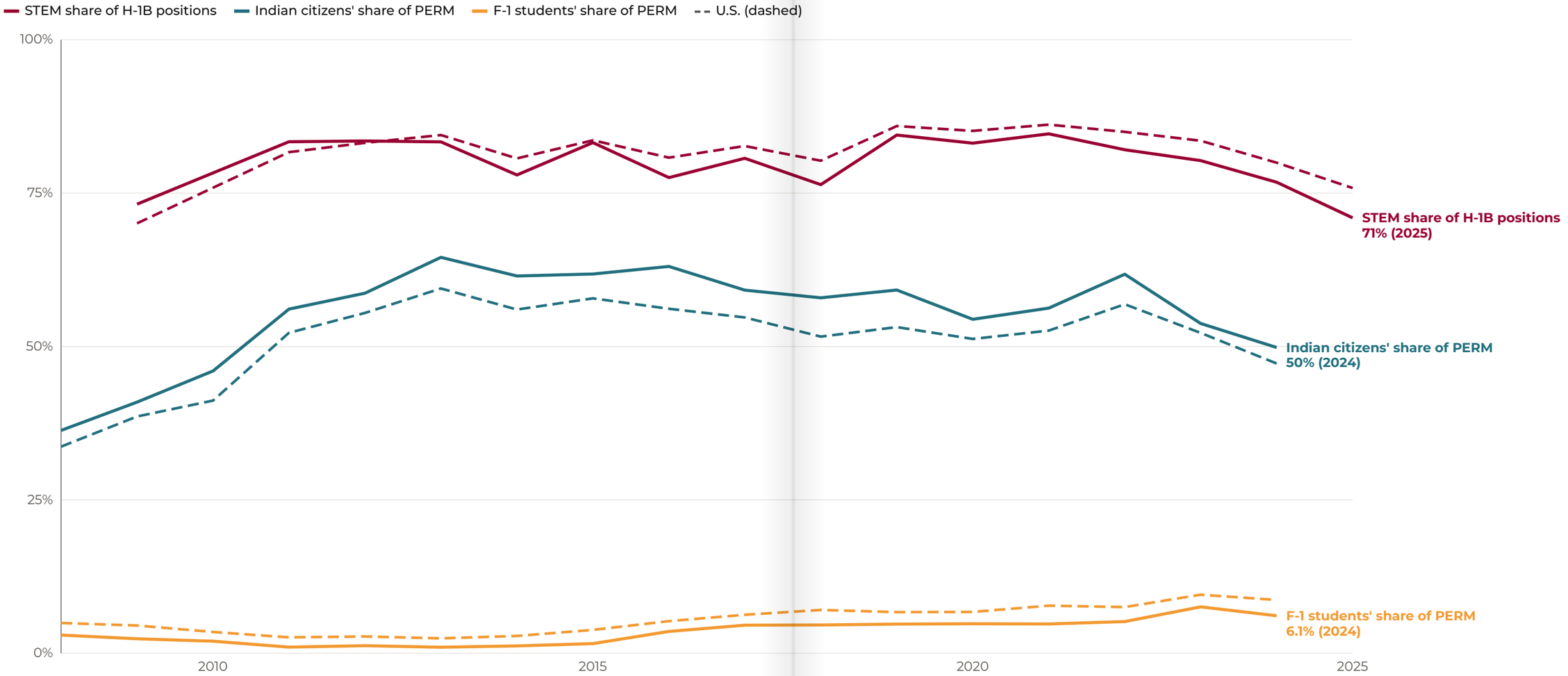
U.S. **138K** · **9th** of 51 · +69% since 2015

6.1%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **40th** of 51 · +4.5 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds Massachusetts's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

71% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 50% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

71%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **21st** of 51 · −12.3 pp since 2015

50%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **15th** of 51 · −12.0 pp since 2015

$120K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

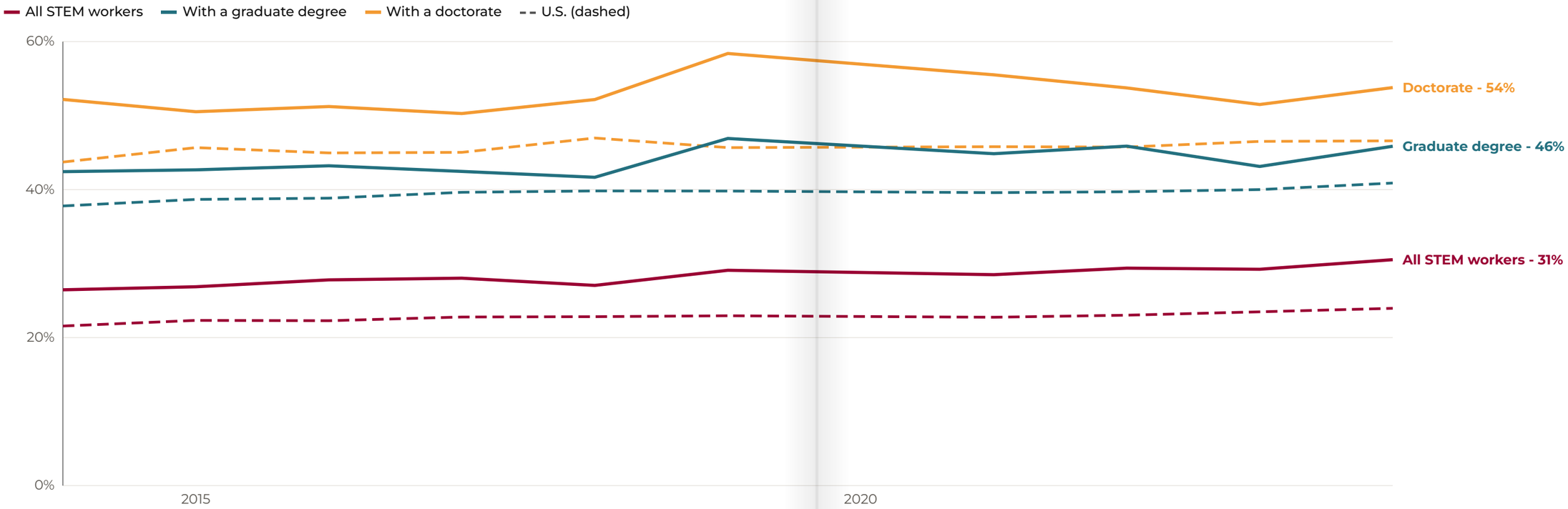
U.S. **$119K** · **6th** of 51 · +60% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Massachusetts ranks 5th of 51 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers, at 31% in 2024 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 20 How Much of Massachusetts's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 31% of the people working in STEM occupations in Massachusetts were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 5th of 51).

The share rises with education: 46% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%), and 54% of those with a doctorate (U.S. 47%; 4th of 20). 15% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.

31%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **5th** of 51 · +3.7 pp since 2015

46%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **5th** of 44 · +3.2 pp since 2015

15%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

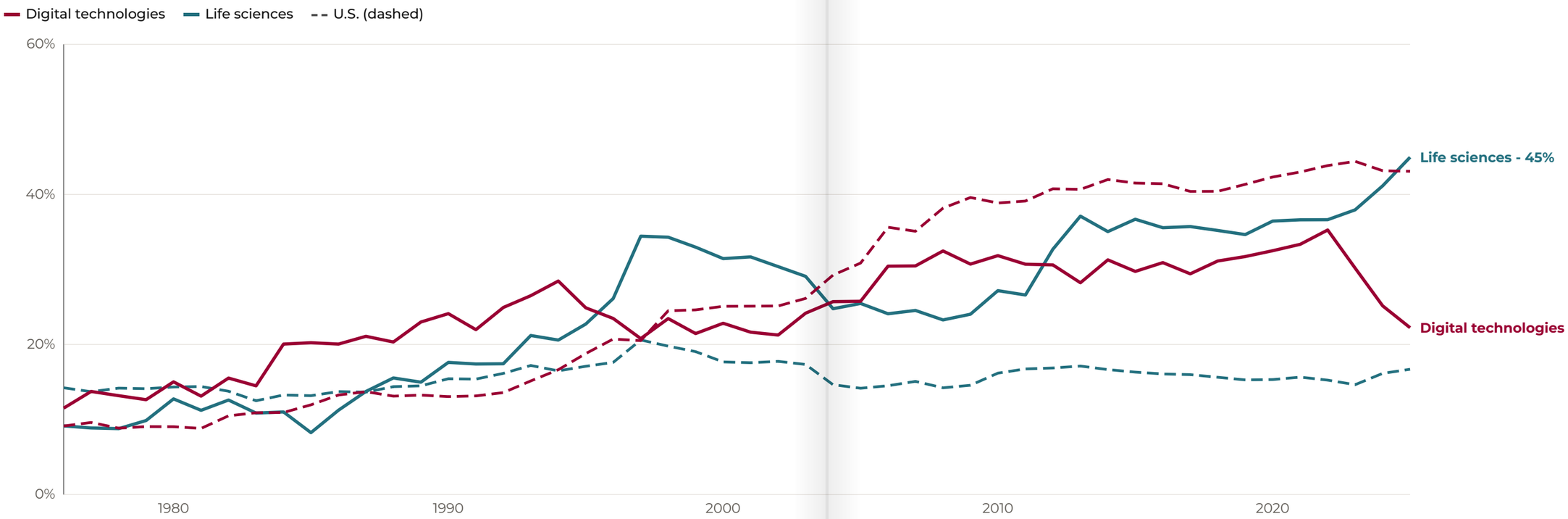
U.S. **11%** · **5th** of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Massachusetts ranks 1st of 51 on the share of the state's patents in life sciences, at 45% in 2025 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Massachusetts Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in Massachusetts were granted 6.3K U.S. patents in 2025, 4.7% of all patents with a U.S. owner (4th of 51). 22% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 45% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

6.3K

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **4th** of 51 · −12% since 2015

22%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **27th** of 51 · −7.5 pp since 2015

45%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

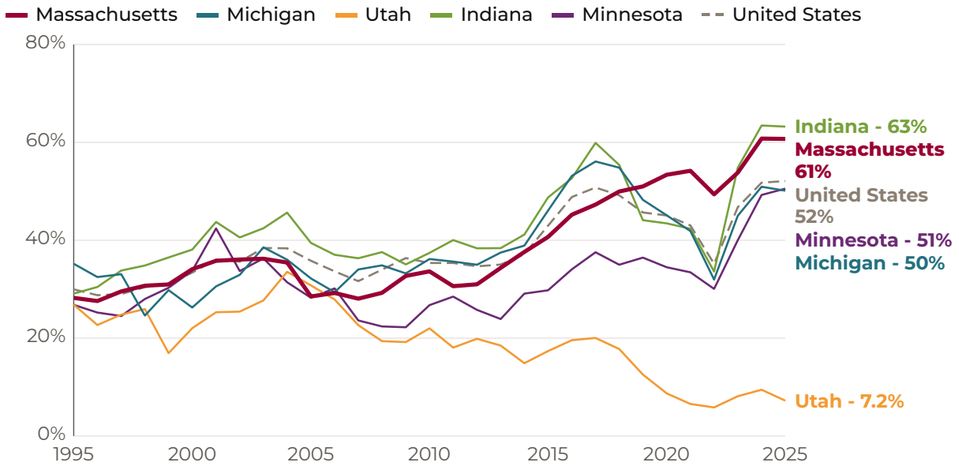
U.S. **17%** · **1st** of 51 · +8.3 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are Michigan, Utah, Indiana, and Minnesota. Massachusetts ranks 2nd of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Indiana is the most dependent at 63%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Massachusetts and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



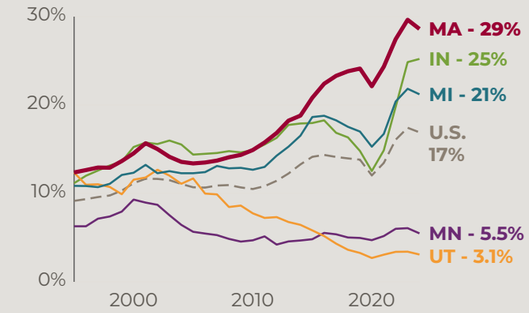
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 4 How Does Massachusetts Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	MA	MI	UT	IN	MN	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**482K**	481K	475K	493K	411K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**31%**	15%	16%	21%	27%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**31%**	30%	25%	27%	18%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**30%**	31%	14%	20%	7.9%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**9.1K**	3.17K	378	4.1K	1.07K	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**7.8%**	2.7%	0.3%	3.5%	0.9%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**61%**	50%	7.2%	63%	51%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**43%**	43%	26%	54%	33%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**29%**	21%	3.1%	25%	5.5%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**7.9%**	3.3%	1.7%	3.0%	2.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**74%**	67%	58%	66%	68%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$15K**	$14.6K	$7.47K	$10.2K	$13.4K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$17K**	$10.3K	$11.2K	$7.12K	$11.1K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$135K**	$107K	$96.4K	$99.3K	$96.8K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**60%**	86%	59%	67%	78%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**+2**	−1	+32	+19	−15	–

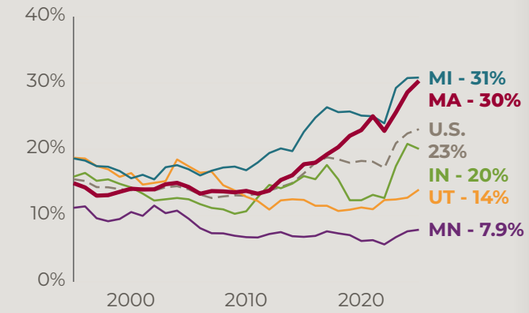
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



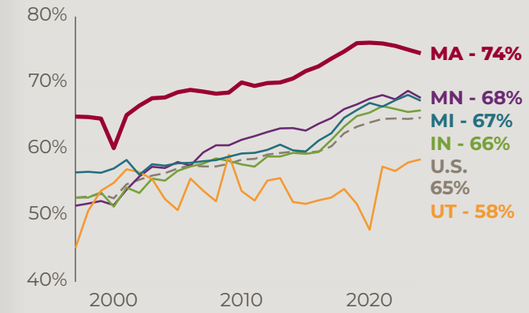
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



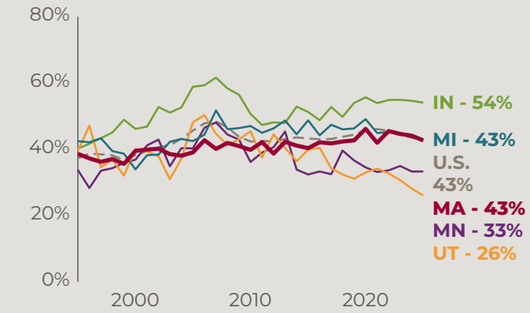
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM doctorates

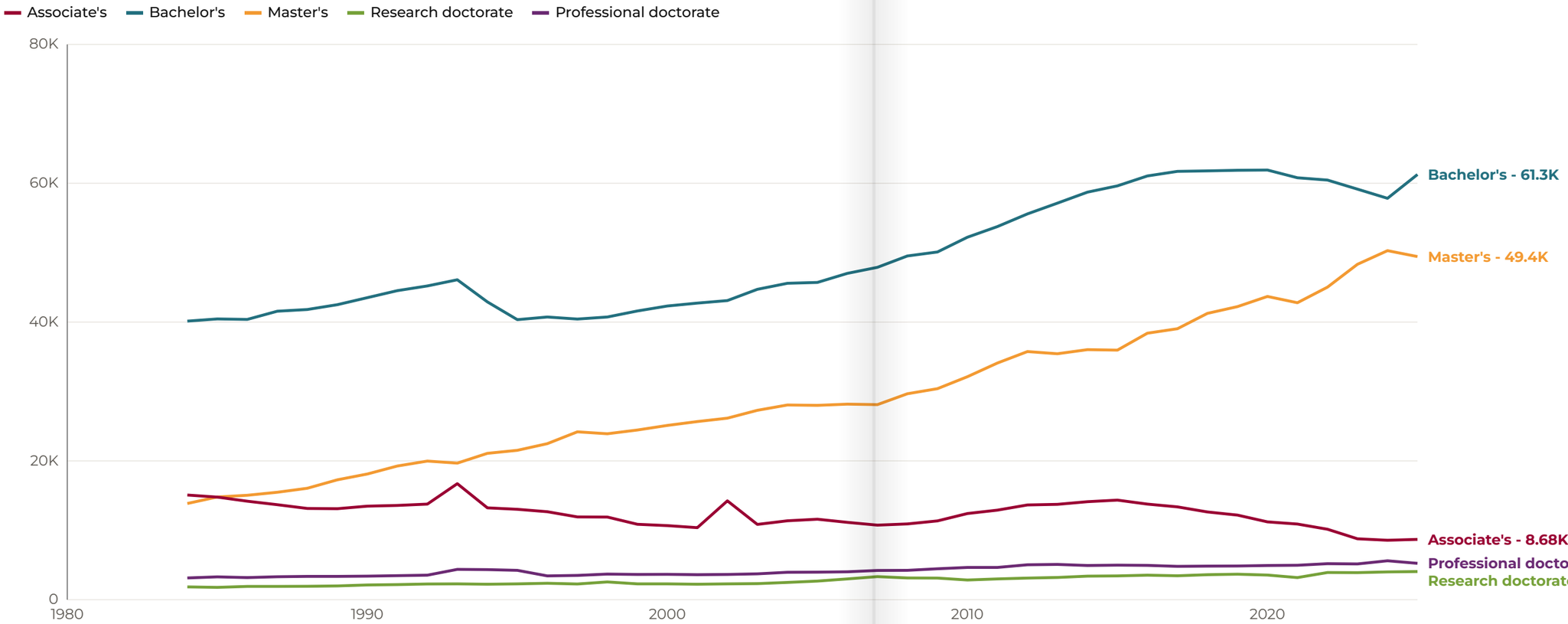


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Massachusetts Award?



Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Massachusetts's institutions awarded 8.68K associate's degrees, 61.3K bachelor's degrees, 49.4K master's degrees, 4.05K research doctorate degrees, 5.25K professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 40%; bachelor's up 3%; master's up 38%; research doctorate up 18%; professional doctorate up 5%. The state awards 18.3 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do Massachusetts's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Massachusetts's largest bachelor's fields are business (17%; U.S. 19%), health professions (9.3%; U.S. 13%), computer & info sciences (9.1%; U.S. 6.9%).

Relative to the nation, Massachusetts's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in area & ethnic studies (1.82× the U.S. share), math & statistics (1.73× the U.S. share), architecture (1.51× the U.S. share).

9.1%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **5th** of 51 · +5.7 pp since 2015

8.1%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

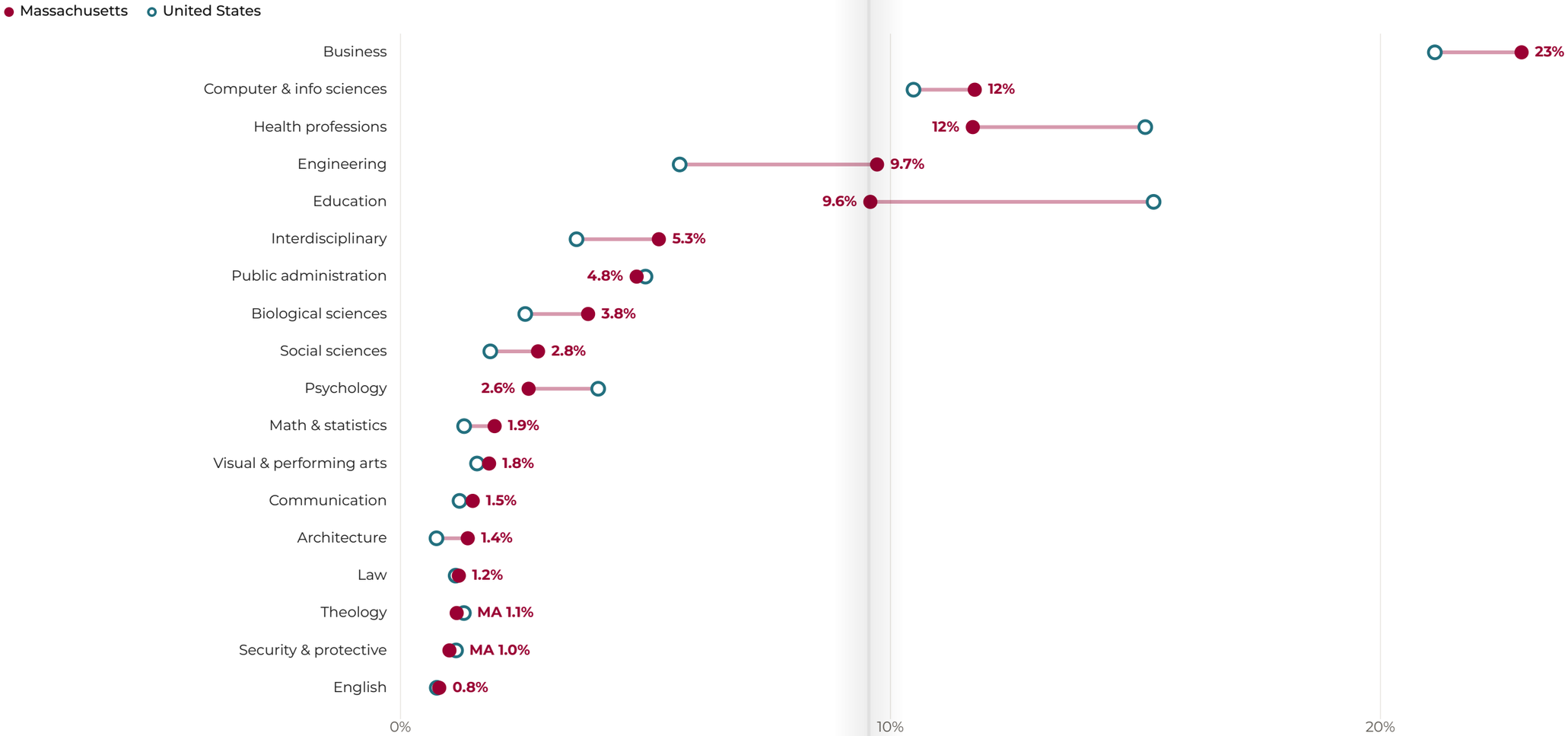
U.S. **6.8%** · **12th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

17%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **36th** of 51 · −0.6 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do Massachusetts's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Massachusetts's largest master's fields are business (23%; U.S. 21%), computer & info sciences (12%; U.S. 10%), health professions (12%; U.S. 15%).

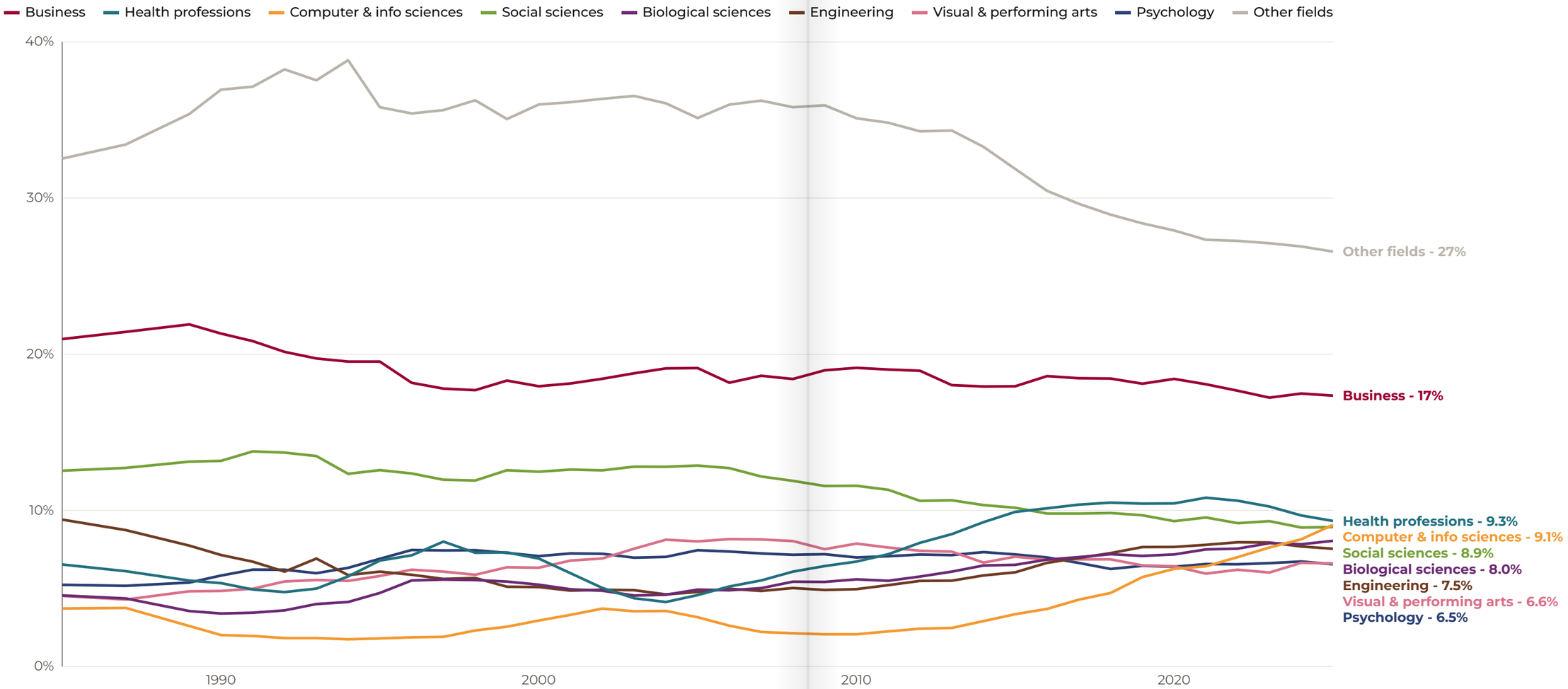
International students earn 39% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 30% of them.

30%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **5th** of 51 · +12.6 pp since 2015

39%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **2nd** of 51 · +15.9 pp since 2015

70%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **18th** of 47 · +17.3 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has Massachusetts's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, computer & info sciences has gained the most ground, 5.7 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while social sciences lost the most (1.2 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is Massachusetts Specialized, and What Do Its Doctoral Graduates Study?

The location quotient divides a field's share of Massachusetts's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Area & ethnic studies (1.82, with 0.5% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.3% for the U.S.), math & statistics (1.73, with 2.0% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.2% for the U.S.), and architecture (1.51, with 0.9% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.6% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is Massachusetts Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Area & ethnic studies	**1.82**	0.5%	0.3%	325
Math & statistics	**1.73**	2.0%	1.2%	1.24K
Architecture	**1.51**	0.9%	0.6%	523
Social sciences	**1.48**	8.9%	6.0%	5.47K
Visual & performing arts	**1.45**	6.6%	4.6%	4.04K
History	**1.39**	1.4%	1.0%	879
Physical sciences	**1.33**	1.7%	1.3%	1.05K
Computer & info sciences	**1.32**	9.1%	6.9%	5.56K
English	**1.31**	2.0%	1.5%	1.2K
Engineering	**1.28**	7.5%	5.9%	4.62K

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

31%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **5th** of 51

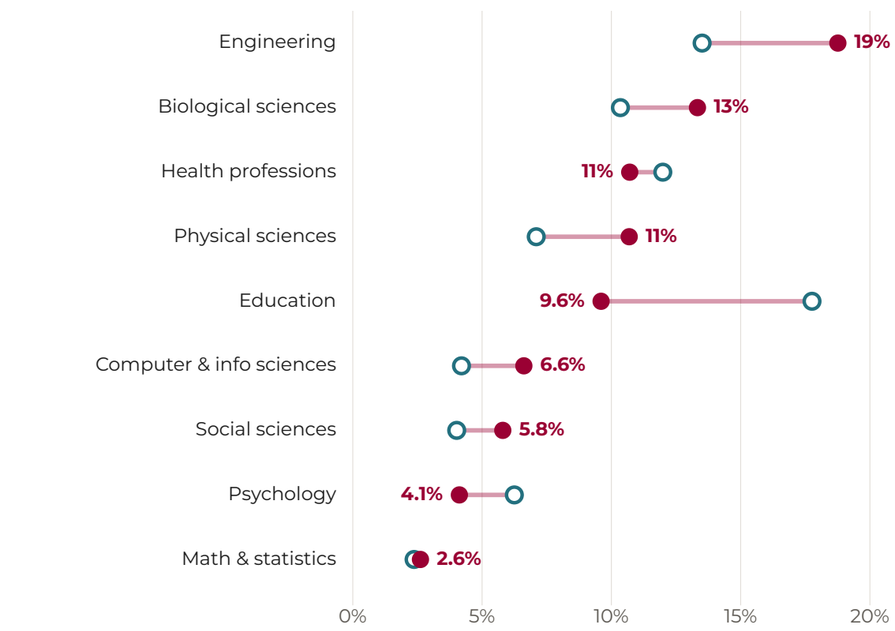
9.1%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **5th** of 51

8.1%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **12th** of 51

Each row is a field's share of the research doctorates awarded in Massachusetts in 2025 (filled dot), against its share nationally (open dot), for the ten largest fields with at least 20 doctorates. Research doctorates exclude professional doctorates such as the M.D. and J.D.

Largest doctoral fields. The state's largest doctoral fields were engineering (19% of research doctorates, against 14% for the U.S.), biological sciences (13% of research doctorates, against 10% for the U.S.), and health professions (11% of research doctorates, against 12% for the U.S.).

Figure 31 What Do Massachusetts's Doctoral Graduates Study?



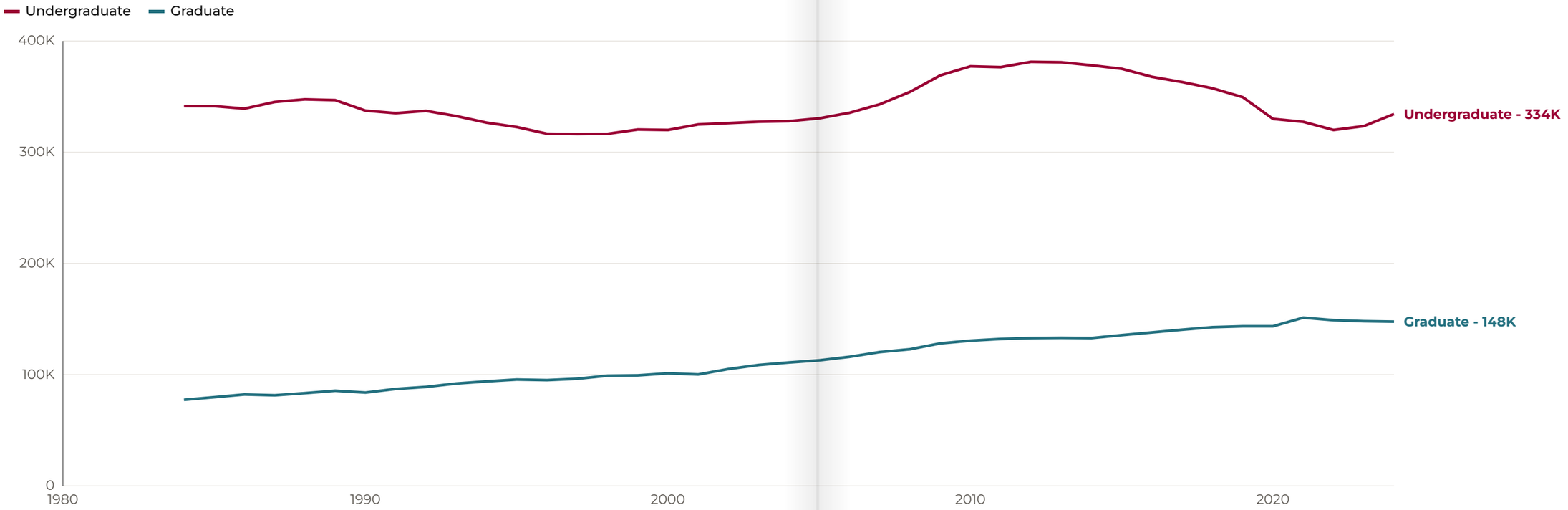
Share of research doctorates by field, 2025; fields with 20+ doctorates. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Massachusetts ranks 2nd of 51 on the share of students who are graduate students, at 31% in 2024 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 32 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Massachusetts enrolled 334K undergraduates and 148K graduate students, 482K in all (13th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 11% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 9% since 2015. Graduate students are 31% of all students (U.S. 17%).

482K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **13th** of 51 · −5.6% since 2015

31%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **2nd** of 51 · +4.1 pp since 2015

30%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **44th** of 51 · −1.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

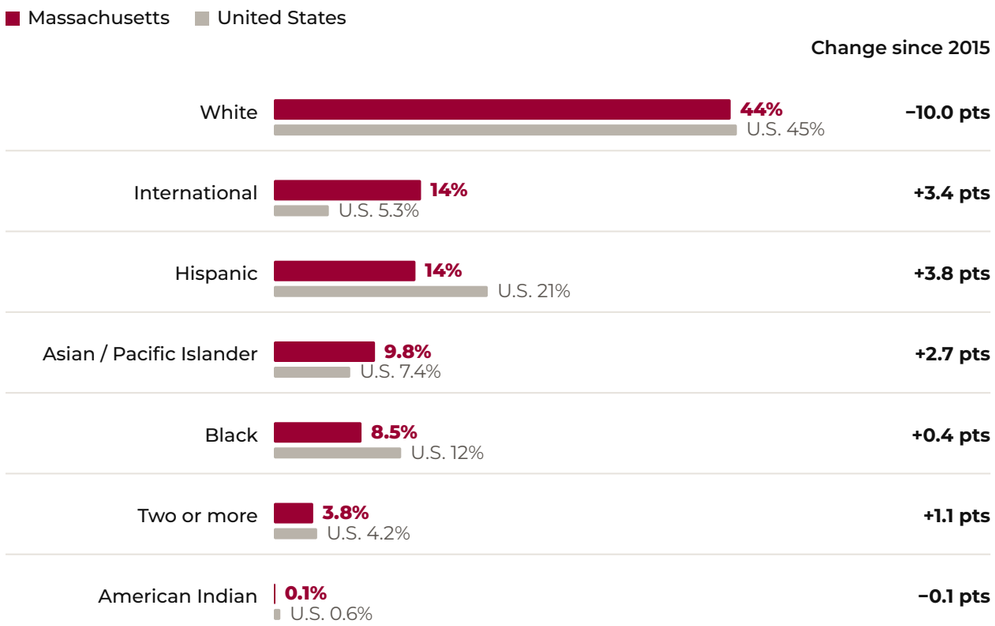
Who Enrolls in Massachusetts, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at Massachusetts's degree-granting institutions, **44%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 10.0 points since 2015.

International students were **14%** (U.S. 5.3%), up 3.4 points since 2015, and Hispanic students were **14%** (U.S. 21%), up 3.8 points since 2015.

Asian and Pacific Islander students were **9.8%** (U.S. 7.4%), up 2.7 points since 2015, and Black students were **8.5%** (U.S. 12%), up 0.4 points since 2015. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race.

Figure 33 Who Enrolls in Massachusetts?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

44%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −10.0 pp since 2015

14%
International students
U.S. **5.3%** · +3.4 pp since 2015

60%
At private nonprofit institutions
+4.2 pp since 2015

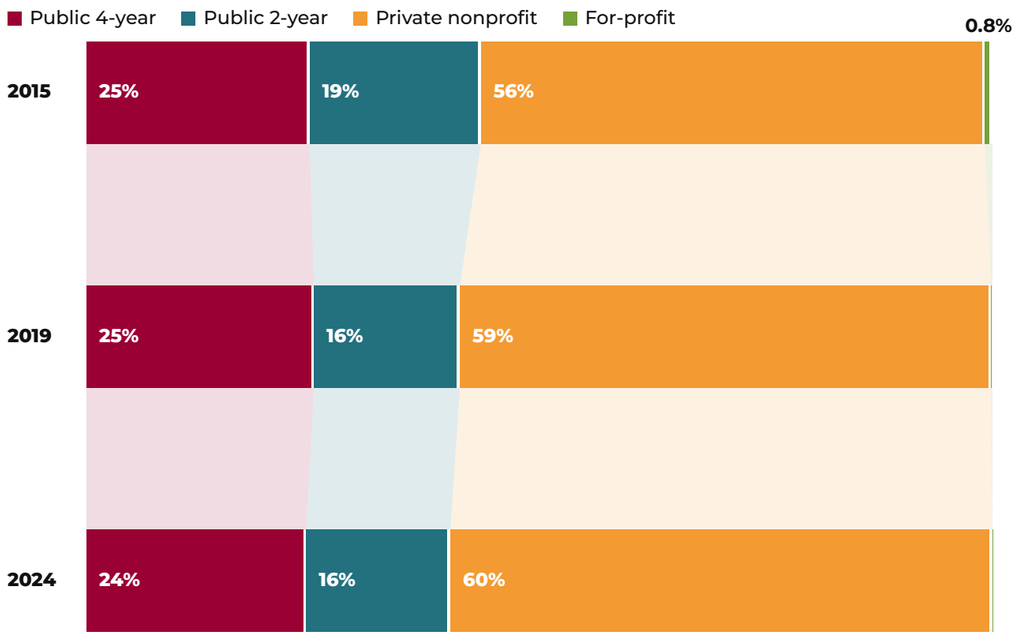
24%
At public 4-year institutions
−0.4 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, private nonprofit institutions enrolled **60%** of students, up 4.2 points from 56% in 2015. Public 4-year institutions enrolled **24%** of students, down 0.4 points from 25% in 2015.

Public 2-year institutions enrolled **16%** of students, down 3.0 points from 19% in 2015, and for-profit institutions enrolled none of the state's students, against 0.8% in 2015.

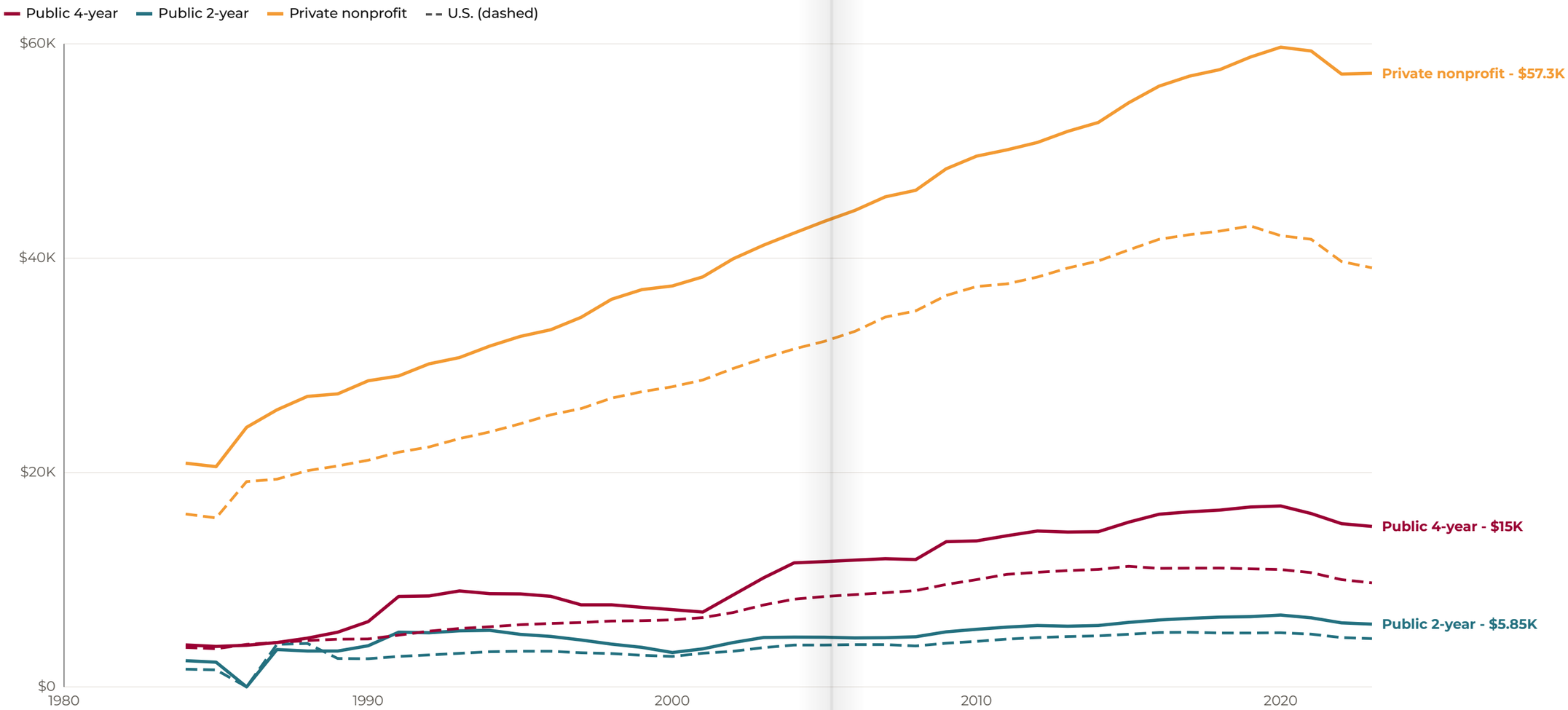
Public institutions together enrolled **40%** of students, against 73% nationally, 49th among the states.

Figure 34 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 35 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Massachusetts's public four-year institutions are $15K (2023, 2024 dollars), 54% above the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 8th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $17K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (6th of 51), and net tuition makes up 39% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).

$15K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **8th** of 51 · −2.6% since 2015

$17K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **6th** of 51 · +64% since 2015

39%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **37th** of 51 · −12.3 pp since 2015

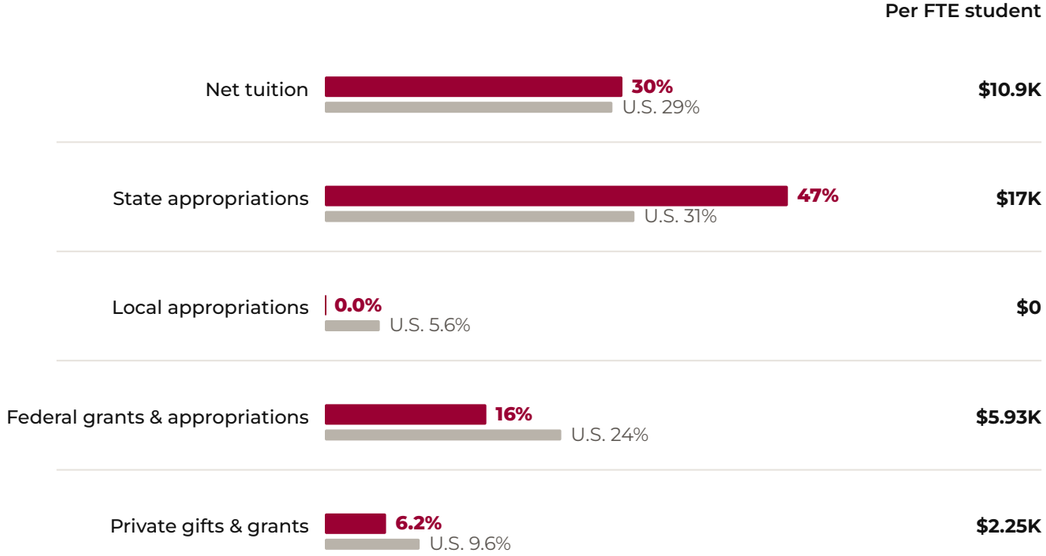
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are Massachusetts's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of Massachusetts's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $10.9K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 7.1% from $11.8K in FY2023 and up 0.1% since FY2015, when it was $10.9K.

Figure 36 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$15K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **8th** of 51

$17K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **6th** of 51

39%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **37th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Massachusetts: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $15K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 8th among the states, down 1.7% from $15.2K in 2022 and down 2.6% since 2015, when it was $15.4K.

Table 6 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Massachusetts	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$15K**	$9.71K	8th of 51	−2.6%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$17K**	$11.4K	6th of 51	+64%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**39%**	43%	37th of 51	−12.3 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**74%**	65%	2nd of 51	+2.7 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$135K**	$106K	2nd of 51	−3.5%

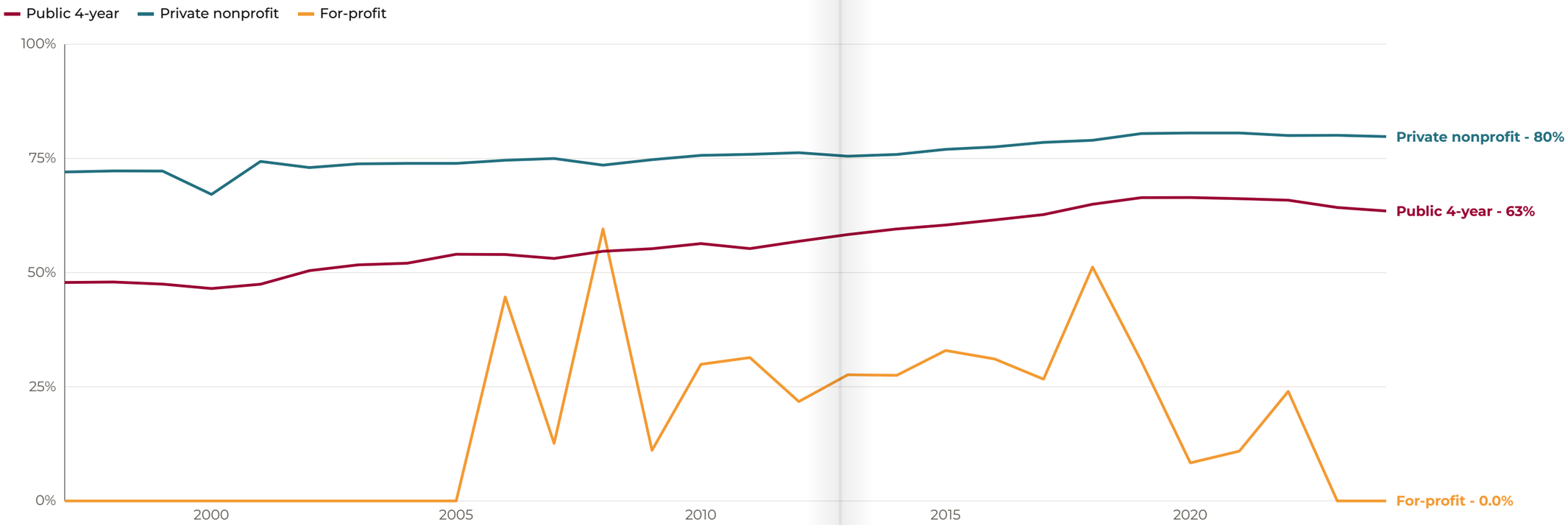
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Massachusetts ranks 2nd of 51 on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 74% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 37 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

74% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Massachusetts graduated within six years (2024), 9.7 points above the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 2nd of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 63%, private nonprofit 80%, for-profit 0.0%. At two-year institutions, 22% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

74%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **2nd** of 51 · +2.7 pp since 2015

22%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **49th** of 50 · +1.9 pp since 2015

18.3
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **3rd** of 51 · +2.6 since 2015

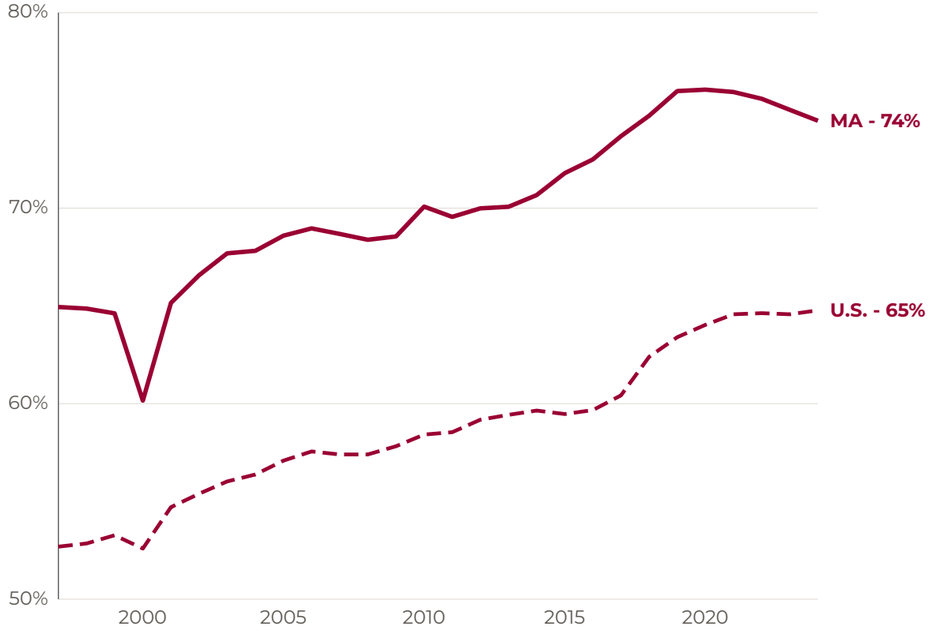
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of Massachusetts's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Massachusetts's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (30% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 74% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., down 0.6 points from 75% in 2023 and up 2.7 points since 2015, when it was 72%.

Figure 38 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

74%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **2nd** of 51

22%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **49th** of 50

18.3
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **3rd** of 51

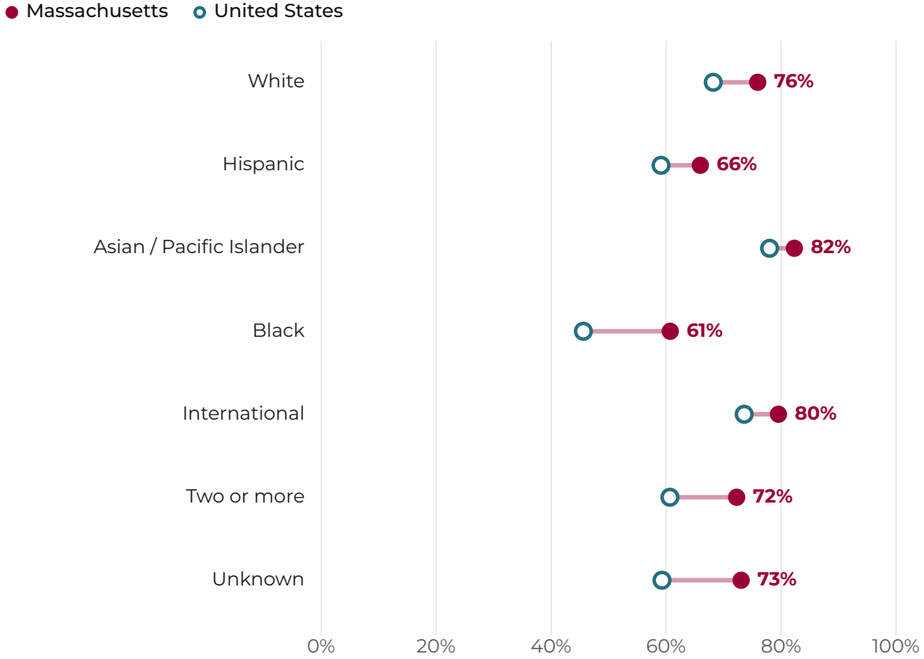
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Massachusetts's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 76% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 66% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 82% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 39 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

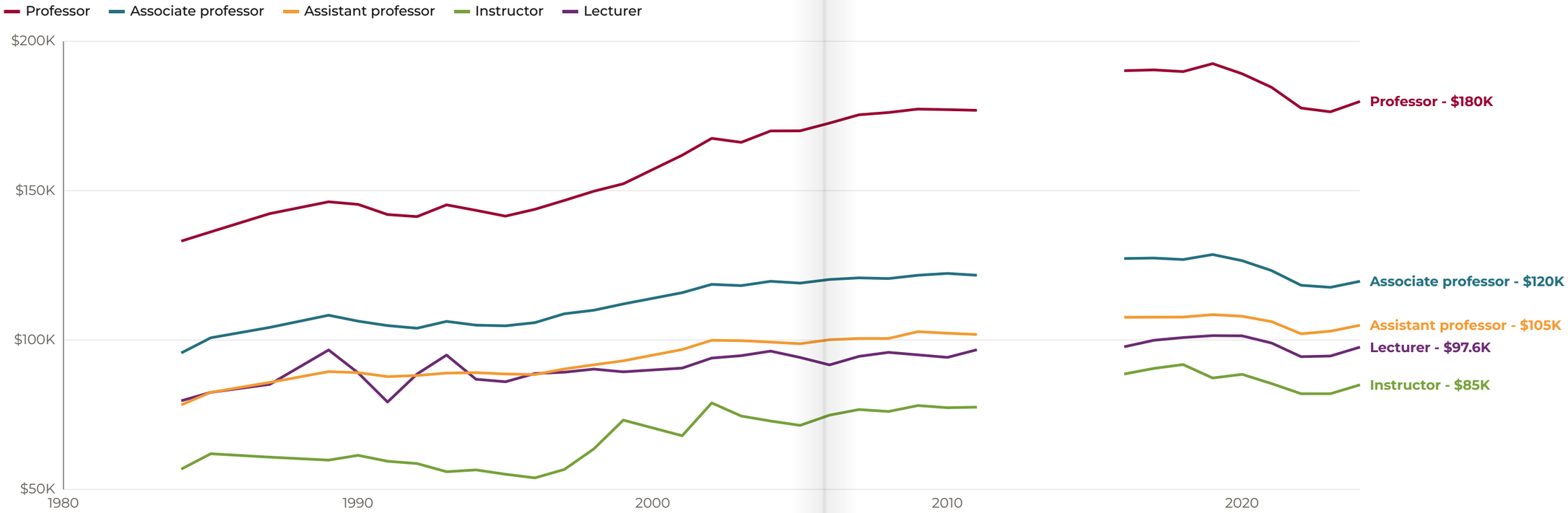
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SECTION 15

Faculty

Massachusetts ranks 2nd of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $135K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 40 What Do Massachusetts's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Massachusetts's institutions earned an average of $135K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 28% above the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 2nd of 51. By rank (2024): professors $180K, associate professors $120K, assistant professors $105K, instructors $85K, lecturers $97.6K.

Massachusetts's institutions had 26.1K full-time instructional staff in 2024, up 5% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 3% since 2016.

$135K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **2nd** of 51 · −3.5% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

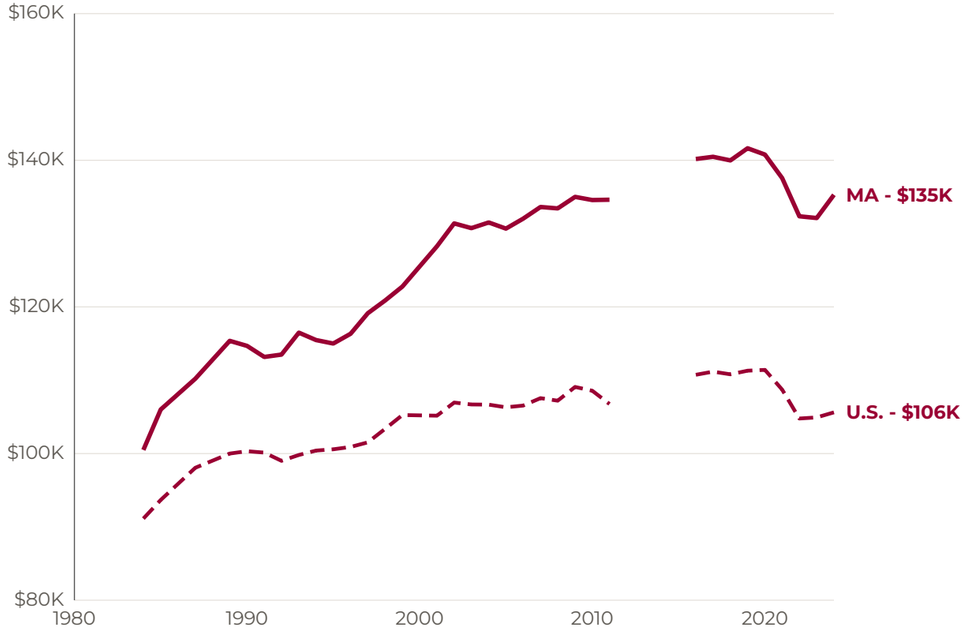
What Do Massachusetts's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Massachusetts's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $135K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 2nd among the states, up 2.4% from $132K in 2023 and down 3.5% since 2016, when it was $140K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 26.1K in 2024, down 0.1% from 26.1K in 2023 and up 5.3% since 2015, when it was 24.8K.

Figure 41 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$135K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **2nd** of 51

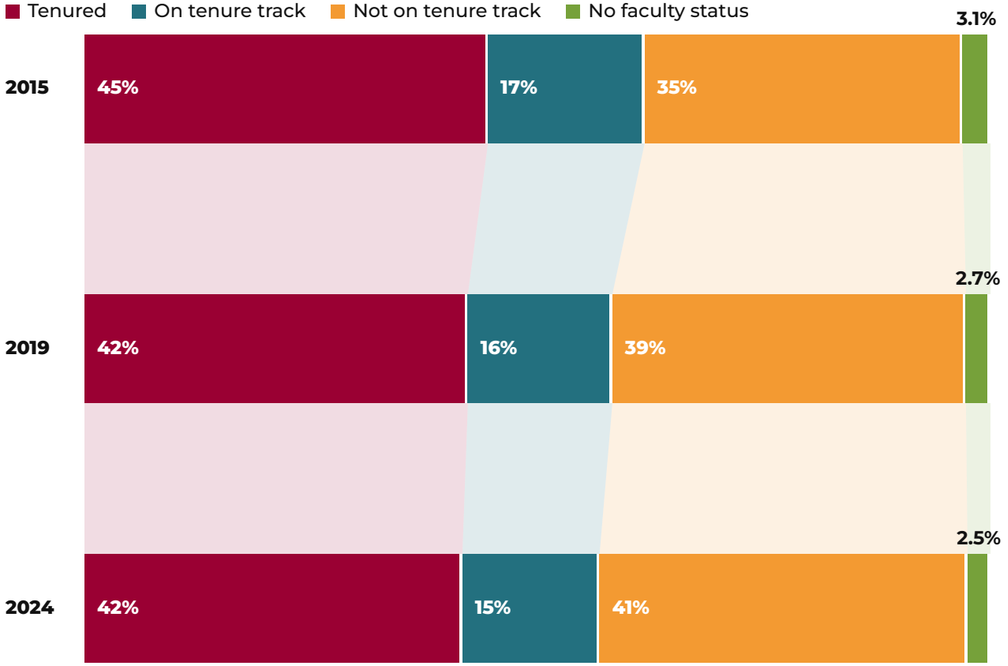
26.1K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

42%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide Massachusetts's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 42% in 2024, unchanged from 42% in 2023 and down 2.8 points since 2015, when it was 45%.

Figure 42 Tenure Status



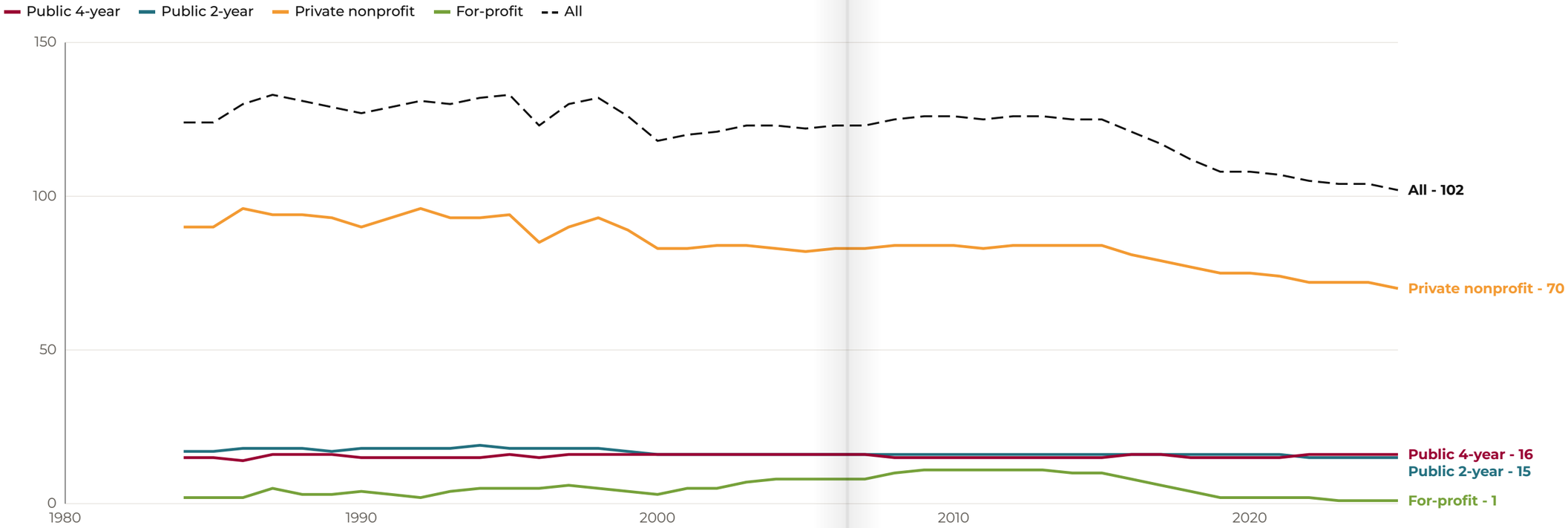
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

Massachusetts ranks 49th of 51 on the share of enrollment at public institutions, at 40% in 2024 against 73% for the U.S.

Figure 43 How Many Institutions Does Massachusetts Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Massachusetts has 102 degree-granting institutions:16 public 4-year, 15 public 2-year, 70 private nonprofit, 1 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 18% since 2015. 40% of students attend public institutions and 0.0% attend for-profit ones.

40%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **49th** of 51 · −3.4 pp since 2015

0.0%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **44th** of 51 · −0.8 pp since 2015

17%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **45th** of 51 · +9.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in Massachusetts?

The table ranks institutions in Massachusetts by the STEM master's degrees and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025, the two counted together. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

Largest. Northeastern University (4.16K international STEM master's degrees and 121 doctorates), Boston University (886 international STEM master's degrees and 110 doctorates), and Massachusetts Institute of Technology (457 international STEM master's degrees and 244 doctorates) awarded the most.

Table 7 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
Northeastern University Boston · Private nonprofit	**4.16K**	81%	121	51%
Boston University Boston · Private nonprofit	**886**	50%	110	44%
Massachusetts Institute of Technology Cambridge · Private nonprofit	**457**	40%	244	39%
Northeastern University Professional Programs Boston · Private nonprofit	**671**	92%	–	–
Harvard University Cambridge · Private nonprofit	**475**	46%	159	36%
University of Massachusetts-Amherst Amherst · Public 4-year	**509**	58%	100	52%
Clark University Worcester · Private nonprofit	**550**	94%	2	40%
Worcester Polytechnic Institute Worcester · Private nonprofit	**203**	30%	35	47%

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

102
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

40%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **49th** of 51

0.0%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **44th** of 51

17%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **45th** of 51

The table lists Massachusetts's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were Boston University (37.7K students), Northeastern University (32.6K students), and University of Massachusetts-Amherst (31.7K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 102 in 2025, and 101 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 8 What Are Massachusetts's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
Boston University	**37.7K**	32%	1.84K	89%	11%
Northeastern University	**32.6K**	60%	2.84K	91%	5.2%
University of Massachusetts-Amherst	**31.7K**	34%	2.27K	83%	60%
Harvard University	**30.3K**	31%	1.02K	98%	3.6%
University of Massachusetts-Lowell	**16.6K**	16%	988	65%	83%
University of Massachusetts-Boston	**15.6K**	23%	613	49%	84%
Boston College	**15.4K**	19%	638	91%	16%
Tufts University	**13.6K**	17%	780	94%	11%
Massachusetts Institute of Technology	**11.9K**	40%	993	96%	4.5%
Bunker Hill Community College	**9.88K**	–	–	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

Massachusetts – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	297	**283**[2024]	−13.4 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#1	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	51%	**37%**[2024]	−13.6 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#1	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	251	**246**[2024]	−4.1 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#1	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	54%	**51%**[2024]	−2.8 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#1	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	274	**268**[2024]	−6.5 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#1	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	46%	**40%**[2024]	−6.0 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#1	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	235	**225**[2024]	−10.5 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#1	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**162**[2015]	–	153	–	#5	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$21.5K	**$25.3K**[2021]	+18% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#6	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	87%	**90%**[2022]	+3.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#2	[3]
Public high school graduates	65.9K	**66.2K**[2024]	+0.4% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#16	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$98.6K	**$97.6K**[2022]	−1.0% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#2	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	13.4	**12.0**[2022]	−1.4 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#44	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	964K	**916K**[2024]	−5.0% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#17	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	40%	**42%**[2023]	+2.4 pp ▲	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#34	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	8.2%	**11%**[2022]	+2.3 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#12	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	3.9%	**5.3%**[2023]	+1.4 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#27	[3]
High schools offering calculus	78%[2016]	**76%**[2024]	−2.6 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#1	[14]
High schools offering physics	80%[2016]	**81%**[2024]	+0.6 pp ▲	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#9	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	91%[2016]	**84%**[2024]	−7.7 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#25	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	87%[2016]	**90%**[2024]	+2.9 pp ▲	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#24	[14]
High schools offering computer science	77%[2021]	**72%**[2024]	−4.9 pp ▼	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#12	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	80%[2016]	**82%**[2024]	+2.5 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#3	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	43%[2021]	**52%**[2024]	+9.2 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#4	[14]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	42%[2016]	**60%[2024]**	+18.7 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#45	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	17.6[2016]	**20.4[2024]**	+2.8 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#15	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	6.5[2016]	**5.2[2024]**	−1.3 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#3	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	14.2[2016]	**14.1[2024]**	−0.1 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#7	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	19.9[2016]	**14.7[2024]**	−5.3 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#39	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	0.7[2016]	**0.3[2024]**	−0.4 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#48	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	31%	**31%[2025]**	−0.9 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#39	[15]
Fall enrollment	511K	**482K[2024]**	−5.6% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#13	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	44%	**40%[2024]**	−3.4 pp ▼	73%	0.0 pp	#49	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	0.8%	**0.0%[2024]**	−0.8 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#44	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	31%	**30%[2024]**	−1.2 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#44	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	27%	**31%[2024]**	+4.1 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#2	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	7.5%	**17%[2024]**	+9.5 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#45	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	2.84K	**3.26K[2025]**	+15% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#4	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	2.12K	**2.64K[2025]**	+25% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#4	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	5.2%	**5.5%[2025]**	+0.4 pp ▲	–	–	#4	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	509	**632[2025]**	+24% ▲	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#5	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	200	**354[2025]**	+77% ▲	5.07K	+33% ▲	#3	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	3.9	**6.9[2025]**	+3.1 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#15	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	21%	**31%[2025]**	+9.7 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#5	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	3.4%	**9.1%[2025]**	+5.7 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#5	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	6.4%	**8.1%[2025]**	+1.7 pp ▲	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	1.7%	**2.0%[2025]**	+0.4 pp ▲	1.2%	0.0 pp	#3	[4]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	6.5%	**8.0%**[2025]	+1.5 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#8	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	1.9%	**1.7%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#6	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	9.9%	**9.3%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	18%	**17%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#36	[4]
STEM share of master's	18%	**30%**[2025]	+12.6 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#5	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	4.0%	**12%**[2025]	+7.7 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#13	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	7.0%	**10%**[2025]	+3.5 pp ▲	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#3	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**1.9%**[2025]	+1.2 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#7	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	2.7%	**3.8%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#8	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	0.7%	**0.6%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#32	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	11%	**12%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#40	[4]
Share of master's in business	26%	**23%**[2025]	−3.0 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#18	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	48%	**53%**[2025]	+5.4 pp ▲	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#7	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	3.4%	**6.6%**[2025]	+3.2 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#6	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	18%	**19%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#6	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	2.1%	**2.6%**[2025]	+0.5 pp ▲	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#23	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	14%	**13%**[2025]	−0.5 pp ▼	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#17	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	9.9%	**11%**[2025]	+0.8 pp ▲	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#11	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	10%	**11%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#23	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	2.5%	**1.3%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#44	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	15.8	**18.3**[2025]	+2.6 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#3	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	7.2%[2016]	**7.7%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#2	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	2.59K	**9.1K**[2025]	3.51× ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#4	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	4.8%	**7.8%**[2025]	+3.0 pp ▲	–	–	#4	[4]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	7.2%	**7.9%**[2024]	+0.7 pp ▲	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#1	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	21%	**29%**[2024]	+7.8 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#2	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	7.1%	**10.0%**[2025]	+2.9 pp ▲	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#1	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	7.7%	**12%**[2025]	+3.9 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#1	[4]
International share of all master's	23%	**39%**[2025]	+15.9 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#2	[4]
International share of STEM master's	41%	**61%**[2025]	+20.0 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#10	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	53%	**70%**[2025]	+17.3 pp ▲	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#18	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	46%	**63%**[2025]	+17.0 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#3	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	59%	**73%**[2025]	+14.8 pp ▲	55%	+6.1 pp ▲	#3	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	19%	**35%**[2025]	+15.7 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#4	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	37%	**37%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#17	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	29%	**35%**[2025]	+5.3 pp ▲	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#2	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	40%	**43%**[2025]	+2.3 pp ▲	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#24	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences research doctorates	52%	**61%**[2025]	+9.5 pp ▲	56%	+2.0 pp ▲	#12	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	48%	**48%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#32	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics research doctorates	48%	**59%**[2025]	+11.5 pp ▲	53%	+2.9 pp ▲	#9	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	25%	**23%**[2025]	−2.4 pp ▼	23%	−4.3 pp ▼	#24	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	42%	**43%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	38%	−1.1 pp ▼	#13	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	70.2K	**76.7K**[2026]	+9.4% ▲	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#4	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	5.9%	**6.4%**[2026]	+0.6 pp ▲	–	–	#4	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	11%	**29%**[2026]	+17.2 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#16	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	32%	**21%**[2026]	−10.8 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#10	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	44%	**50%**[2026]	+6.3 pp ▲	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#14	[20]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Countries of citizenship represented	193	**187**[2026]	−3.1% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#5	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	21.2K	**44.3K**[2026]	2.09× ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#5	[20]
Active STEM master's students	9.19K	**24.7K**[2026]	2.69× ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#6	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	5.5K	**8.34K**[2026]	+51% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#4	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	41%	**51%**[2026]	+10.3 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#33	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	14.8K[2017]	**15.5K**[2024]	+4.8% ▲	–	–	#5	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$3.2B[2018]	**$3.6B**[2024]	+13% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#3	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	38.8K[2018]	**30.8K**[2024]	−21% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#3	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	5.8%	**7.0%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	–	–	#4	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	5.7%	**7.0%**[2024]	+1.3 pp ▲	–	–	#4	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	6.7%	**7.2%**[2024]	+0.6 pp ▲	–	–	#3	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	19K	**16.3K**[2025]	−14% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#3	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	29.3K	**30K**[2016]	+2.5% ▲	620K	+0.4% ▲	#5	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	11.5K	**12.3K**[2016]	+7.0% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#6	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	39%	**41%**[2016]	+1.7 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#13	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	53%	**53%**[2016]	+0.5 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#26	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	5.07K	**5.33K**[2016]	+5.1% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#2	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	61%	**57%**[2016]	−3.5 pp ▼	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#20	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$3.67B	**$5.5B**[2024]	+50% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#6	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	5.3%	**4.7%**[2024]	−0.7 pp ▼	–	–	#6	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	58%	**54%**[2024]	−4.2 pp ▼	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#22	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	7.2%	**6.4%**[2024]	−0.8 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#9	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	1.4%	**1.0%**[2024]	−0.4 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#47	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$170M	**$338M**[2024]	+99% ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#5	[6]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$779M	**$1.13B**[2024]	+45% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#6	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	39.6K	**45K**[2024]	+14% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#6	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$6.06B	**$9.53B**[2024]	+57% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#6	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$1.6B	**$2.07B**[2024]	+29% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#6	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$2.76B	**$4.36B**[2024]	+58% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#9	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$2.37B	**$3.73B**[2024]	+57% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#3	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$2.96B	**$3.98B**[2025]	+35% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#3	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$2.46B	**$3.11B**[2026]	+652.3 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#7	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$62.6K[2020]	**$61.4K**[2022]	−1.9% ▼	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#3	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$55.1K**[2025]	–	$47.5K	–	#4	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$23.6K	**$20.5K**[2024]	−13% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#9	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$76.6K**[2025]	–	$68.2K	–	#2	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$51.5K**[2025]	–	$51.9K	–	#24	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$76.6K**[2025]	–	$68.1K	–	#3	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$108K**[2025]	–	$91.6K	–	#4	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	72%	**74%**[2024]	+2.7 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#2	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	20%	**22%**[2024]	+1.9 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#49	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$15.4K	**$15K**[2023]	−2.6% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#8	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$10.3K	**$17K**[2024]	+64% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#6	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	51%	**39%**[2024]	−12.3 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#37	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$140K[2016]	**$135K**[2024]	−3.5% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#2	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	46%	**50%**[2016]	+4.7 pp ▲	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#9	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	46%	**53%**[2016]	+6.3 pp ▲	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#16	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	44%	**48%**[2016]	+4.3 pp ▲	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#8	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	48%	**50%**[2016]	+1.8 pp ▲	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#6	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.88	**0.92**[2016]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#21	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	1.42K	**1.81K**[2016]	+28% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#6	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	–	**80%**[2016]	–	72%	–	#3	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**75%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#3	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**70%**[2010]	–	64%	–	#3	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**73%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#5	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**72%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#8	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**48%**[2016]	–	49%	–	#19	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**$48.8K**[2016]	–	$47K	–	#10	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$71.7K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#6	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**$60.4K**[2016]	–	$59.2K	–	#11	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−8.7	**−4.8**[2025]	+4.0 ▲	–	–	#40	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−7.78K	**−2.58K**[2025]	+5,194.0 ▲	–	–	#42	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	2.3%	**2.3%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#35	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	3.1%	**2.8%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	–	–	#20	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	20.4K	**26K**[2025]	+28% ▲	–	–	#7	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	60%[2016]	**60%**[2024]	−0.5 pp ▼	–	–	#40	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+3[2016]	**+2**[2024]	−1.1 ▼	–	–	#30	[4]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	35%[2016]	**39%[2022]**	+3.9 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#9	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	46.5K	**28.1K[2025]**	−40% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#8	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	3.9%	**3.1%[2025]**	−0.8 pp ▼	–	–	#8	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	83%	**71%[2025]**	−12.3 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#21	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$75K	**$120K[2025]**	+60% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#6	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	44%	**13%[2025]**	−30.4 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#34	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	2.66K	**4.5K[2025]**	+69% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#9	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	62%	**50%[2024]**	−12.0 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#15	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	1.6%	**6.1%[2024]**	+4.5 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#40	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	60%	**57%[2024]**	−3.2 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#5	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	79%	**57%[2025]**	−22.5 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#9	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$101K	**$115K[2025]**	+14% ▲	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#7	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	28.5K	**36.2K[2024]**	+27% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#8	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	2.7%	**2.7%[2024]**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#8	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	23.6K	**23.7K[2024]**	+0.5% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#10	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	3.2%	**2.9%[2024]**	−0.3 pp ▼	–	–	#10	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	2.0%	**1.8%[2024]**	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#11	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	3.9%	**3.6%[2024]**	−0.3 pp ▼	–	–	#7	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	2.5%	**2.6%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#10	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	2.1%	**2.7%[2024]**	+0.6 pp ▲	–	–	#5	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	4.02K	**5.4K[2026]**	+34% ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#7	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	6.72K	**11.7K[2026]**	+74% ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#7	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	3.6%	**4.3%[2026]**	+0.7 pp ▲	–	–	#7	[13]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	3.3%	**2.8%**[2026]	−0.5 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#40	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	14%	**8.9%**[2026]	−5.4 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#41	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	47%	**45%**[2026]	−1.8 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#12	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	15%	**19%**[2026]	+3.4 pp ▲	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#45	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	305K	**419K**[2024]	+37% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#13	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	8.6%	**11%**[2024]	+2.2 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#6	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	27%	**31%**[2024]	+3.7 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#5	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	43%	**46%**[2024]	+3.2 pp ▲	41%	+2.2 pp ▲	#5	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a doctorate	51%	**54%**[2024]	+3.2 pp ▲	47%	+0.9 pp ▲	#4	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	14%	**15%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#5	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	9.8%	**9.7%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#5	[12]
Share of foreign-born STEM workers born in India	20%	**22%**[2024]	+1.8 pp ▲	28%	+0.7 pp ▲	#22	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	16%	**19%**[2025]	+3.0 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#6	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	21%	**25%**[2025]	+3.5 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#7	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	285K	**354K**[2025]	+24% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#9	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	1.41	**1.46**[2025]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#3	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$95.1K	**$137K**[2025]	+44% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#4	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$113K[2019]	**$165K**[2025]	+47% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#4	[10]
Software developer jobs	55K	**48.2K**[2025]	−12% ▼	1.69M	+48% ▲	#12	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$59K	**$85.6K**[2025]	+45% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#2	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	7.16K	**6.3K**[2025]	−12% ▼	135K	−0.6% ▼	#4	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	5.3%	**4.7%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	–	–	#4	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	30%	**22%**[2025]	−7.5 pp ▼	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#27	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	37%	**45%**[2025]	+8.3 pp ▲	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#1	[22]

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MASSACHUSETTS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	3.8%	**1.6%**[2025]	−2.2 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#13	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	12%	**16%**[2025]	+4.2 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#5	[22]

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